

ENGLISH FOR THE SHOP FLOOR AND CHECKOUT

Retail Associate and Cashier English

Helpful service. Accurate details.

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Eight scenarios. Eight extended conversations.

INSIDE THE BOOK

192 vocabulary entries / 128 reusable phrases
160 dialogue turns / 80 numbered dialogue gaps
Word banks and explained answer keys

Upper-intermediate to advanced (B2-C1). For retail associates, cashiers, collection-desk staff, customer-service colleagues, and shift supervisors.

2026 edition

Eight scenarios. Eight skills.

Eight retail conversations: identify an advertised item, compare garment labels, explain a quantity offer, correct a duplicate scan, discuss an exchange, clarify collection status, offer accessible checkout assistance, and hand over an unverified till difference.

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Helpful does not mean guessing.

A strong retail conversation identifies the exact item, explains the relevant condition, and makes the next step clear. Careful language protects the shopper from a wrong variation or price and helps colleagues distinguish checked facts from unfinished work.

Identify before promising stock

Color alone may not identify an advertised product. Confirm the item reference, material, size, and location before making an availability claim or offering an unrequested substitute.

"You mean the medium cotton shirt C218; I have not checked local stock yet."

State the condition with the price

A two-item offer does not necessarily give one item half the bundle price. State the qualifying quantity and the complete amount for each option without pressuring the shopper to buy more.

"One bottle is \$3; two qualifying bottles are \$5."

Separate eligibility from completion

Meeting a fictional exchange policy does not establish replacement stock. An order acknowledgment is not a collection notice, and correcting an unpaid basket is not the same as issuing a refund.

"The exchange conditions are met, but I still need to check the larger size."

Keep help and handovers specific

Ask which assistance the shopper prefers. At shift change, name unfinished checks and their owner without turning a difference into an accusation or an accepted task into a completed one.

"The recorded count is \$5 below expected; the second check is pending and the cause is unknown."

PROFESSIONAL BOUNDARIES

All stores, shoppers, prices, product references, balances, offers, and policies are fictional. This book teaches workplace English, not legal advice, payment-system operation, accounting investigation, or accessibility certification. Follow actual store procedures, product information, payment-security requirements, applicable consumer and accessibility laws, and emergency arrangements. A fictional exchange policy does not replace statutory rights. Ask before providing personal assistance or handling a shopper's belongings or mobility aid.

Which blue shirt?

A Read the situation

Use a reference, material, and size to identify a product before making an unverified local-stock claim.

Shopper Casey asks associate Hana for the blue shirt in an advertisement. The advertisement contains two blue shirts: linen L214 and cotton C218. Casey wants the cotton version in medium, not the linen version or another size. Local availability has not been checked. Hana confirms C218, blue, medium, and cotton before beginning a stock inquiry. No item has been located, reserved, or sold, and the advertisement does not prove that the requested variation is available at this branch.

PEOPLE / Casey: Shopper | Hana: Retail associate

CLARIFICATION IS PART OF HELPING

A shopper may reasonably remember the image rather than an item number. Narrow the choice with a short concrete question, then read back the product details. Avoid making the shopper repeat the whole story or treating a displayed advertisement as proof of local availability.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which product does Casey mean?

- | | |
|---------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| A A different unmentioned item | B Cotton C218 |
| C Linen L214 | D Either blue shirt |

2. Which size is requested?

- | | |
|-----------------------------|-----------------|
| A Any available size | B Medium |
| C Small | D Large |

3. What is known about local stock?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A The item is definitely available | B The item is definitely sold out |
| C One has already been reserved | D It has not been checked |

Answers and explanations: [page 76](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

item reference

Identifier used to distinguish a product.

IN USE confirm the item reference

stock-keeping unit

Internal identifier for a stocked product variation, often abbreviated SKU.

IN USE check the stock-keeping unit

barcode

Machine-readable code used to identify an item or record.

IN USE scan the barcode

product variation

Specific version differing in size, color, or another feature.

IN USE confirm the product variation

colorway

Color version offered within a product range.

IN USE identify the blue colorway

size

Labelled dimension category such as medium.

IN USE confirm the requested size

cotton

Textile fiber identified for the requested shirt in this case.

IN USE identify the cotton version

linen

Different textile fiber used in the other advertised shirt.

IN USE distinguish the linen version

fiber content

Information describing the fibers used in a textile.

IN USE check the fiber content

advertised item

Product featured in a promotion or advertisement.

IN USE identify the advertised item

product image

Picture of a product, not proof of local stock.

IN USE compare the product image

range

Group of related products or variations.

IN USE identify the product range

Precision check

The exact request is blue cotton C218 in medium. Linen L214 is a different item even though it is also blue. Confirming the product does not establish stock, a reservation, or permission to substitute another variation.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

local availability

Whether the exact variation is available at the relevant branch.

IN USE check local availability

branch

Particular store location within a retailer.

IN USE identify the branch

shop floor

Customer-accessible area where merchandise is displayed.

IN USE check the shop floor

stockroom

Storage area for merchandise not on the selling floor.

IN USE check the stockroom

display sample

Item shown for viewing, not necessarily available for sale.

IN USE distinguish a display sample

stock inquiry

Request to check whether a specific item is available.

IN USE make a stock inquiry

stock record

System record of recorded merchandise quantities or status.

IN USE consult the stock record

physical check

Verification of the actual item and its location.

IN USE request a physical check

reservation

Confirmed arrangement to hold an item under the store process.

IN USE distinguish a reservation

substitution

Replacement with a different item or variation requiring agreement.

IN USE discuss a substitution

specification

Set of details defining the requested item.

IN USE repeat the specification

availability claim

Statement that an item can be supplied, requiring support.

IN USE avoid an unsupported availability claim

Precision check

A stock-keeping unit, item reference, and barcode may identify different levels of detail in a retailer's system. Use the actual system correctly and read back the shopper-facing details; do not assume a familiar-looking code proves the size or local availability.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

NARROW THE ADVERTISEMENT

"The ad shows two blue shirts; do you mean cotton or linen?"

NAME THE SELECTED REFERENCE

"The cotton shirt is C218."

READ BACK THE REQUEST

"Blue cotton C218 in medium; is that right?"

AVOID AN ADVERTISEMENT ASSUMPTION

"The advertisement does not confirm stock at this branch."

ASK FOR THE SIZE

"Which size are you looking for?"

DISTINGUISH THE OTHER ITEM

"L214 is the linen version."

SEPARATE IDENTIFICATION AND STOCK

"I have identified the item, but I have not checked local availability yet."

CONFIRM BEFORE SEARCHING

"I will use that exact reference and size for the stock inquiry."

The blue shirt

A shared color may still leave more than one possible item.

In medium

It introduces the requested size rather than a different product name.

Cotton versus linen

The material distinction identifies separate advertised products in this case.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

KEEP ALTERNATIVES OPTIONAL

"I would ask before offering a different size or material."

CLARIFY THE LOCATION

"Are you asking about availability at this branch?"

KEEP THE RECORD PRECISE

"Medium cotton, not medium linen."

INVITE CORRECTION

"Please tell me if I have the size or material wrong."

AVOID A RESERVATION CLAIM

"Nothing has been reserved yet."

EXPLAIN THE NEXT STEP

"The next step is to check the requested variation."

AVOID PREMATURE CERTAINTY

"I cannot confirm available or sold out before the check."

CLOSE THE CLARIFICATION

"The item is confirmed; its stock status is still unknown."

Yet

Not checked yet means unresolved, not unavailable.

At this branch

Limits the availability question to a specific store location.

Identified versus reserved

Identifying the correct item does not create a hold or confirm stock.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which read-back is accurate?

- A** Blue cotton C218 in medium.
- B** Blue linen L214 in medium.
- C** Any blue shirt in any size.
- D** Cotton C218 in large without asking.

2. Which stock statement is supported?

- A** A copy is already reserved.
- B** Local availability has not been checked yet.
- C** The advertisement guarantees one here.
- D** The medium version is sold out.

3. Which next step follows the clarification?

- A** Mark the sale complete.
- B** Check the exact requested variation.
- C** Substitute linen without asking.
- D** Promise a medium based on the photo.

4. Which distinction should a colleague receive?

- A** C218 is cotton; L214 is linen.
- B** Both references are interchangeable.
- C** Blue proves the same material.
- D** Medium automatically means local stock.

[Answers and explanations: page 76.](#)

Which blue shirt?

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

specification / advertised item / stock inquiry / substitution / cotton / item reference / local availability / reservation / size / product variation

- 01 **Casey:** I am looking for the blue shirt in this advertisement. I liked the picture, but I did not write down the item number.
- 02 **Hana:** There are two blue shirts in the ad. Let us confirm the ¹ _____ before I check stock. Do you mean the cotton one or the linen one?
- 03 **Casey:** The cotton one, please. I noticed the other blue shirt too, but it is not the material I came in to find.
- 04 **Hana:** The ² _____ version is C218. The linen version has a different reference, L214, even though the colors look similar in the advertisement.
- 05 **Casey:** C218 sounds like the one. I need a medium, not a small. I would rather wait for the right size than take a different one.
- 06 **Hana:** I will keep the ³ _____ specific. You are asking for medium in the blue cotton C218, not whichever blue shirt happens to be on the nearest rack.
- 07 **Casey:** Exactly. Does the advertisement mean you have that version here, or does it only show something from the store's range?
- 08 **Hana:** It shows the ⁴ _____, but it does not establish stock at this branch. I have not checked local availability for the medium yet.
- 09 **Casey:** That is useful to know. I do not want to hear that it is available and then discover that the only one is a different size.
- 10 **Hana:** The ⁵ _____ matters. I will keep the reference, material, color, and size together when I make the inquiry.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 10.

- 11 **Casey:** Please do. I am asking about this location today, not whether a different branch might have something similar.
- 12 **Hana:** Understood. The first question is ⁶ _____ here. If we later discuss another location or an alternative, I will make that distinction explicit.
- 13 **Casey:** Has one been put aside already, or are we still at the stage of finding out whether the right shirt is present?
- 14 **Hana:** No ⁷ _____ has been made. We have identified the request, but no item has yet been located or set aside.
- 15 **Casey:** Good. I prefer that clear answer. Would you read the details back once before checking, just so we do not start with the wrong reference?
- 16 **Hana:** The ⁸ _____ is blue cotton shirt C218 in medium. L214 is the linen shirt and is not the one you want.
- 17 **Casey:** That is right. If there is only linen or another size, please ask me rather than treating it as an equivalent replacement.
- 18 **Hana:** Any ⁹ _____ would be a separate choice for you. I will not change the material or size simply to turn an uncertain stock result into a sale.
- 19 **Casey:** Thank you. We have found the right product description, so the remaining question is whether this branch actually has it.
- 20 **Hana:** Yes. The next step is the ¹⁰ _____ for that exact variation. Until it is checked, I will not describe it as available, sold out, or reserved.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 77

1. item reference | 2. cotton | 3. size | 4. advertised item | 5. product variation | 6. local availability | 7. reservation | 8. specification | 9. substitution | 10. stock inquiry

Identify a different advertised item

F Say it

An advertisement shows red wool W310 and red cotton C314 sweaters. The shopper wants red cotton C314 in large. Local stock is unchecked, and no item is reserved.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

large / unchecked / C314 / reserved

Associate: "The requested reference is ¹ _____."

Shopper: "The requested size is ² _____."

Associate: "Local stock remains ³ _____."

Shopper: "Nothing has been ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 77

1. C314 | 2. large | 3. unchecked | 4. reserved

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The care label decides the comparison

A Read the situation

Compare stated garment features and care requirements without inventing comfort, fit, or durability claims.

Shopper Luis needs a machine-washable jacket and compares two \$60 options with associate Priya. Jacket A is unlined and its label permits machine washing. Jacket B is lined and its label says dry-clean only. No other care details, durability tests, or fit measurements are supplied. A meets the stated washing requirement on the available label information; B does not. Luis asks to look at A next but has not tried it on or purchased it. Priya must not infer washing suitability from the presence or absence of a lining.

PEOPLE / Luis: Shopper | Priya: Retail associate

USE EVIDENCE INSTEAD OF CONFIDENT SALES LANGUAGE

Words such as comfortable, durable, and easy-care can mean different things to different shoppers. Compare the label facts with the stated need, and distinguish a feature from a tested benefit. A useful recommendation can be conditional without sounding evasive.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which jacket meets the stated machine-washing requirement?

A B, because it is lined

B Both, because they cost the same

C Neither, because A is unlined

D A, according to its label

2. What do the two jackets cost?

A \$60 for the pair

B A \$60 and B \$90

C \$60 each

D A \$30 and B \$60

3. What is unverified?

A Fit, comfort, and durability

B A's unlined construction

C B's dry-clean-only label

D The stated equal prices

Answers and explanations: page 78.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

garment

Item of clothing.

IN USE compare the garments

care label

Label stating how a garment should be cared for.

IN USE read the care label

machine-washable

Suitable for machine washing under the actual label instructions.

IN USE check the machine-washable claim

dry-clean only

Label instruction restricting cleaning to dry cleaning.

IN USE explain the dry-clean-only instruction

hand wash

Care instruction specifying washing by hand.

IN USE distinguish a hand-wash instruction

lining

Inner layer of a garment.

IN USE identify the lining

lined

Made with an inner lining.

IN USE describe the lined jacket

unlined

Made without a separate inner lining.

IN USE describe the unlined jacket

outer fabric

Material forming the garment's external surface.

IN USE identify the outer fabric

fiber blend

Combination of different fibers in a textile.

IN USE read the fiber blend

woven fabric

Textile formed by interlacing sets of yarns.

IN USE identify woven fabric

knit fabric

Textile formed through interlocking loops.

IN USE distinguish knit fabric

Precision check

The care label, not the lining, answers the washing question. A is unlined and permits machine washing; B is lined and says dry-clean only. Do not extend these two examples into a rule about all lined or unlined jackets.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

seam

Line where pieces of fabric are joined.

IN USE inspect the seam

hem

Finished edge of a garment or fabric section.

IN USE identify the hem

cuff

Finished section at the end of a sleeve.

IN USE compare cuff styles

fastening

Part used to close or secure the garment.

IN USE check the fastening

zipper

Sliding fastening with interlocking elements.

IN USE inspect the zipper

fit

How the garment sits on the individual wearer.

IN USE check the fit

cut

Overall shaping or silhouette of a garment.

IN USE compare the cut

size chart

Guide relating labelled sizes to stated measurements.

IN USE consult the size chart

measurement

Quantified dimension used to compare fit.

IN USE check the measurement

shrinkage

Reduction in dimensions, not ruled out by an unsupported claim.

IN USE avoid a shrinkage guarantee

colorfastness

Ability of a textile to retain color under specified conditions.

IN USE check colorfastness information

durability claim

Statement about resistance to wear that needs support.

IN USE avoid an unsupported durability claim

Precision check

Both prices are \$60 each. Equal price does not imply equal care, fit, comfort, or durability. The shopper has asked to inspect A, not confirmed that it fits or completed a purchase. Use actual label details for any further care question.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ASK ABOUT THE REQUIREMENT

"Is machine washing a requirement for you?"

READ THE SECOND LABEL

"Jacket B's label says dry-clean only."

AVOID AN INFERENCE

"The lining alone does not tell us how to clean it."

CONNECT FACT AND NEED

"A meets your stated washing requirement on the label information."

READ THE FIRST LABEL

"Jacket A's label permits machine washing."

COMPARE CONSTRUCTION

"A is unlined; B has a lining."

STATE THE EQUAL PRICES

"Both jackets are \$60 each."

KEEP FIT SEPARATE

"We still need to check how it fits you."

Each versus together

Sixty dollars each does not mean sixty dollars for both jackets.

Permits versus recommends

Use the actual wording supplied rather than strengthening or changing the instruction.

Only

Dry-clean only excludes treating the garment as machine-washable in this comparison.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID A COMFORT CLAIM

"I cannot establish comfort from the price or lining alone."

OFFER INSPECTION

"Would you like to look at A more closely?"

AVOID INVENTED SETTINGS

"No washing temperature has been supplied in this comparison."

INVITE A PRACTICAL CHECK

"You can compare the fit before making your choice."

AVOID A DURABILITY PROMISE

"We do not have evidence here that one will last longer."

USE THE FULL LABEL

"We should check the actual instructions for any further care detail."

CLARIFY PURCHASE STATUS

"Looking at A does not mean you have decided to buy it."

SUMMARIZE THE EVIDENCE

"Same price, different care instructions, fit still unverified."

Feature versus benefit

A lining is a construction feature, not automatic proof of comfort or durability.

Meets the requirement

This applies to the specified washing need, not every possible shopping preference.

Not tried on

Fit remains unverified until the relevant practical check occurs.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which recommendation uses the supplied evidence?

- A** A meets your machine-washing requirement according to its label.
- B** All unlined jackets can be machine washed.
- C** B must wash well because it costs the same.
- D** A is guaranteed more comfortable.

2. Which comparison is unsupported?

- A** B will definitely last longer because it has a lining.
- B** Both jackets cost \$60 each.
- C** A is unlined.
- D** B's label says dry-clean only.

3. Which statement preserves the purchase status?

- A** Asking about A authorizes payment.
- B** Luis wants to inspect A but has not tried it on or bought it.
- C** Luis has confirmed A fits perfectly.
- D** Both jackets have been purchased.

4. What should resolve a further washing-temperature question?

- A** A guess based on the price
- B** Assuming all cotton settings apply
- C** Copying instructions from a different jacket
- D** The actual care-label instructions

Answers and explanations: page 78.

The care label decides the comparison

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

washing temperature / durability claim / comfort claim / machine-washable / size chart / care label / lining / only / each / fit

- 01 **Luis:** I need a jacket I can machine wash. These two are the same price, but I am not sure which one fits that requirement.
- 02 **Priya:** Let us check the ¹ _____ on each. Jacket A permits machine washing, while jacket B says dry-clean only.
- 03 **Luis:** I noticed B has an inner layer and A does not. Is that the reason one needs different care, or should I not assume that?
- 04 **Priya:** B has a ² _____, and A is unlined. Those are construction details, but the lining alone does not establish the cleaning requirements or their cause.
- 05 **Luis:** Then A is the one to look at for my washing requirement. I do not want to choose B and assume I can wash it anyway.
- 06 **Priya:** On the information here, A is ³ _____ under its label instructions. That meets the specific care requirement you have stated.
- 07 **Luis:** Does dry-clean only mean something stronger than a suggestion that dry cleaning might give a nicer finish?
- 08 **Priya:** Yes. The word ⁴ _____ is important in B's instruction. I should not describe that label as permission to machine wash the jacket.
- 09 **Luis:** Are they really both sixty dollars? I want to make sure one price is not for a different size or for two items together.
- 10 **Priya:** Both are sixty dollars ⁵ _____. The equal prices do not mean the care instructions or other characteristics are identical.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 19.

- 11 **Luis:** That helps. I would like to look at A, although I have not tried either one on yet. I still need to see how it sits on me.
- 12 **Priya:** Of course. The ⁶ _____ is a separate question. Meeting your washing requirement does not tell us whether this particular jacket fits you as you want.
- 13 **Luis:** Could the lined one be more comfortable, though? I have heard people say that, but I do not know whether it applies to these jackets.
- 14 **Priya:** I cannot make a ⁷ _____ from the lining alone. We can compare the stated features without promising how either will feel to you.
- 15 **Luis:** And I suppose the same applies to saying one will last longer. I do not see any test information here.
- 16 **Priya:** Correct. A ⁸ _____ would need support. We have not checked evidence that one of these jackets will last longer than the other.
- 17 **Luis:** Please show me A first, then. I want to inspect it and check the fit, not decide to buy before I have looked properly.
- 18 **Priya:** I can help you with that. We can check the ⁹ _____ and the actual garment information rather than treating the washing label as a complete recommendation.
- 19 **Luis:** Good. If I have a question about washing temperature later, I will ask to see the actual instructions instead of guessing.
- 20 **Priya:** That is the right detail to verify. The ¹⁰ _____ has not been confirmed in our discussion, and I will not invent one. For now, A meets the stated care requirement, with fit and purchase still open.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 79

1. care label | 2. lining | 3. machine-washable | 4. only | 5. each | 6. fit | 7. comfort claim | 8. durability claim | 9. size chart | 10. washing temperature

Compare another pair of care labels

F Say it

Jacket C is lined and permits machine washing. Jacket D is unlined and says dry-clean only. Both are \$70 each. The shopper requires machine washing and has tried neither on.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

each / fit / C / only

Associate: "Jacket ¹ _____ meets the stated washing requirement."

Shopper: "Both jackets cost seventy dollars ² _____."

Associate: "Jacket D says dry-clean ³ _____."

Shopper: "The ⁴ _____ remains unverified."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 79

1. C | 2. each | 3. only | 4. fit

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

One bottle is not half the bundle

A Read the situation

03

Explain a quantity condition, distinguish average and single-item prices, and respect the shopper choice.

Shopper Nia has one juice bottle with a regular single-bottle price of \$3. The shelf offer is two qualifying bottles for \$5; single bottles remain \$3. Nia expects one bottle to cost \$2.50. Associate Ben explains that \$2.50 is the average per bottle only when buying the qualifying pair. Two at regular prices would cost \$6, so the pair saves \$1 against that comparison, but it requires \$2 more total spending than one \$3 bottle. Nia chooses one bottle at \$3. No other charges apply in the exercise.

PEOPLE / Nia: Shopper | Ben: Retail associate

EXPLAIN THE OFFER WITHOUT PUSHING THE EXTRA PURCHASE

A lower average price does not necessarily serve a shopper who needs only one item. State the quantity condition and both complete totals neutrally. Distinguish saving against two regular-price items from spending less than the single item already chosen.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is the price of one bottle?

A \$6

B \$3

C \$2.50

D \$5

2. What qualifies for the \$5 offer?

A One bottle alone

B Any unrelated item

C Half a bottle

D Two qualifying bottles

3. Which choice does Nia make?

A One bottle at \$3

B Two bottles at \$5

C One bottle at \$2.50

D Two bottles at \$3

Answers and explanations: page 80.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

shelf label

Displayed product and price information at the shelf.

IN USE check the shelf label

multibuy offer

Promotion requiring purchase of a specified number of items.

IN USE explain the multibuy offer

qualifying item

Product that meets the offer's stated conditions.

IN USE identify a qualifying item

quantity condition

Required number of items for an offer.

IN USE state the quantity condition

single-item price

Price charged when buying one item alone.

IN USE confirm the single-item price

regular price

Non-promotional price used as the stated comparison.

IN USE compare regular prices

bundle total

Complete price for the grouped qualifying items.

IN USE state the bundle total

average price

Total divided by the number of items, not necessarily the one-item selling price.

IN USE explain the average price

price per item

Amount per individual item under the specified purchase conditions.

IN USE compare the price per item

unit pricing

Price stated per standard quantity such as a liter or kilogram.

IN USE distinguish unit pricing

comparison basis

Quantity and conditions used to calculate a saving.

IN USE identify the comparison basis

saving

Reduction against the specified comparison amount.

IN USE calculate the saving

Precision check

Two bottles for \$5 works out to \$2.50 per bottle only within that qualifying purchase. It does not change the stated \$3 single-bottle price. One bottle and two bottles are different purchase quantities with different complete totals.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

03

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

extra spending

Increase in total outlay compared with another purchase choice.

IN USE explain the extra spending

minimum purchase

Smallest quantity or spend needed to qualify.

IN USE clarify the minimum purchase

mix-and-match

Offer allowing specified different items to form a qualifying group.

IN USE check mix-and-match eligibility

exclusion

Item or condition not covered by an offer.

IN USE explain an exclusion

promotion period

Dates during which an offer applies.

IN USE check the promotion period

loyalty price

Price available under a stated membership condition.

IN USE clarify the loyalty price

coupon

Voucher or code offering a benefit under specified terms.

IN USE check a coupon

redemption condition

Requirement for using a coupon or offer.

IN USE explain redemption conditions

price query

Shopper question about the amount or conditions charged.

IN USE resolve a price query

quantity read-back

Confirmation of the number of items selected.

IN USE give a quantity read-back

basket total

Total for the shopper's selected goods.

IN USE confirm the basket total

purchase preference

Shopper's choice among clearly explained options.

IN USE respect the purchase preference

Precision check

The pair saves \$1 compared with two bottles at \$3 each. It still costs \$2 more than buying only one \$3 bottle. Always name the comparison basis before saying cheaper or saves money; do not imply a larger basket necessarily lowers total spending.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

03

ACKNOWLEDGE THE CALCULATION

"I see how you arrived at \$2.50 by dividing the pair price."

CONFIRM THE SINGLE PRICE

"One bottle on its own remains \$3."

GIVE BOTH COMPLETE TOTALS

"One is \$3; two qualifying bottles are \$5."

CALCULATE THE SAVING

"The pair saves \$1 compared with that \$6 total."

STATE THE CONDITION

"The \$5 offer applies to two qualifying bottles."

EXPLAIN THE AVERAGE

"\$2.50 is the average per bottle when you buy the pair."

NAME THE COMPARISON

"Two at the regular price would cost \$6."

EXPLAIN THE EXTRA OUTLAY

"It is still \$2 more spending than buying one bottle."

For versus each

Two for \$5 gives a group price; \$3 each describes the regular single price here.

Average versus sale price

Division explains the pair's average but does not create a one-item offer.

Compared with

This phrase names the baseline for a saving claim.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

03

AVOID A FALSE SINGLE PRICE

"The bundle average is not the one-bottle selling price."

AVOID ADDING CONDITIONS

"No membership condition is stated in this offer."

ASK FOR THE CHOICE

"Would you prefer one at \$3 or two at \$5?"

READ BACK QUANTITY

"The selected quantity is one, not the pair."

KEEP QUALIFICATION EXPLICIT

"We should check that both bottles qualify for the offer."

RESPECT THE NEED

"You do not have to buy a second bottle to keep the single-item option."

CONFIRM THE SELECTION

"You have chosen one bottle at \$3."

CLOSE THE QUERY

"The offer is clear, and your single-bottle choice remains unchanged."

Qualifying

The offer applies only to products meeting the stated terms.

More spending versus better value

A lower per-item price can still require a higher total payment.

Choice versus pressure

Explain both options without treating the larger purchase as the only sensible one.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which explanation is accurate?

- A** All juice products are automatically included.
- B** \$2.50 is the pair's average per bottle; one alone is \$3.
- C** One bottle must be \$2.50 because five divided by two is 2.5.
- D** The offer requires three bottles.

2. What is the saving on the pair against two regular-price bottles?

- A** \$1
- B** \$2
- C** \$2.50
- D** \$3

3. How much more does the pair cost than buying one bottle?

- A** \$1
- B** Nothing
- C** \$2.50
- D** \$2

4. Which response respects the final choice?

- A** I added another bottle because the average is lower.
- B** You must buy two now that I explained the offer.
- C** One bottle is \$5 because you declined the pair.
- D** One bottle at \$3; I will keep that quantity.

Answers and explanations: [page 80](#).

One bottle is not half the bundle

E Conversations / turns 1-10

03

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

quantity condition / purchase preference / quantity read-back / extra spending / qualifying items / basket total / price query / single-item price / comparison basis / average price

- 01 **Nia:** The shelf says two for five dollars, so I expected this one bottle to be two fifty. Why is the single price showing three dollars?
- 02 **Ben:** The offer has a ¹ _____. Five dollars applies when you buy two qualifying bottles; one bottle on its own remains three dollars.
- 03 **Nia:** I divided five by two. The arithmetic seemed straightforward, so I thought that was what each bottle would cost even if I only took one.
- 04 **Ben:** That gives the ² _____ within the pair. It is two fifty per bottle when the purchase meets the two-bottle condition.
- 05 **Nia:** So the calculation is right, but I used it for a different purchase quantity than the offer actually describes.
- 06 **Ben:** Exactly. The ³ _____ is still three dollars. The pair costs five dollars in total, rather than changing every individual purchase to two fifty.
- 07 **Nia:** Are both bottles supposed to be part of that particular offer? I should not assume another product can make up the pair.
- 08 **Ben:** Correct. They must be ⁴ _____. We would check the actual products against the shelf offer rather than assume any second item qualifies.
- 09 **Nia:** I only need one today. Before I decide, how much does the offer save compared with buying two at the usual price?
- 10 **Ben:** The ⁵ _____ is two bottles at three dollars each, which would be six dollars. The five-dollar pair saves one dollar against that total.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

03

Continue with the word bank on page 28.

- 11 **Nia:** That is different from saying I spend less than I would on the single bottle I already have in my basket.
- 12 **Ben:** Yes. The pair requires two dollars of ⁶ _____ compared with your one-bottle purchase. A lower average price does not mean a lower total than buying only one.
- 13 **Nia:** Thank you. I would rather keep the extra two dollars today because I do not need the second bottle.
- 14 **Ben:** That is a clear ⁷ _____. The single-bottle option remains available at three dollars; there is no need to change your quantity to justify that choice.
- 15 **Nia:** Please keep it to one, then. I mainly wanted to understand the shelf wording, not have another bottle automatically added.
- 16 **Ben:** I will give a ⁸ _____: one bottle only. Explaining the offer does not mean you have accepted the two-bottle purchase.
- 17 **Nia:** Is there a membership condition I have missed as well, or is the issue here simply that I have one bottle instead of two?
- 18 **Ben:** No membership condition is stated in this offer. This ⁹ _____ is about the required quantity and the difference between an average and a single price.
- 19 **Nia:** That answers it. One at three dollars is what I want, and I understand why dividing the pair price does not change that amount.
- 20 **Ben:** Your ¹⁰ _____ for this choice is three dollars. The selected quantity stays one, and no second bottle has been added.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 81

1. quantity condition | 2. average price | 3. single-item price | 4. qualifying items | 5. comparison basis | 6. extra spending | 7. purchase preference | 8. quantity read-back | 9. price query | 10. basket total

Explain a different quantity offer

F Say it

One qualifying soup can is \$4. The offer is three qualifying cans for \$10, with no other charges. The shopper selects one can. Three at regular prices would cost \$12.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

three / two / four / one

Associate: "The offer requires ¹ _____ qualifying cans."

Shopper: "My one-can choice costs ² _____ dollars."

Associate: "The bundle saves ³ _____ dollars against three regular-price cans."

Shopper: "My selected quantity remains ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 81

1. three | 2. four | 3. two | 4. one

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

One mug, two recorded entries

A Read the situation

Correct a duplicate before payment and distinguish the revised basket total from a refund or completed transaction.

Shopper Leo has one mug priced at \$8, but cashier Amira has scanned it twice. The checkout record shows two mugs and \$16. No other charges apply in the exercise, and payment has not begun. Amira acknowledges the duplicate, corrects the recorded quantity through the store checkout process, and reads back one mug at \$8. Leo confirms the correction. No money has been taken, no refund is required for this unstarted payment, and the exchange ends before payment completion.

PEOPLE / Leo: Shopper | Amira: Cashier

MAKE THE CORRECTION VISIBLE IN THE EXPLANATION

A shopper should not need to infer that a total changed correctly. Acknowledge the exact error, explain the corrected quantity, and read back the revised total before payment. Avoid calling an unpaid-basket correction a refund, which can make the transaction sound further along than it is.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is the actual quantity?

A Sixteen mugs

C Two mugs

B One mug

D Eight mugs

2. What is the corrected total?

A \$0

C \$16

B \$8

D \$24

3. What is the payment status?

A Payment has not begun

C Payment was declined

B Payment has been refunded

D Payment is completed

Answers and explanations: page 82.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

checkout

Place or process for recording and paying for purchases.

IN USE check the checkout total

point-of-sale system

System recording sales and payments, often abbreviated POS.

IN USE use the point-of-sale system

scan

Read an item code into the checkout record.

IN USE scan the item

duplicate scan

Recording the same intended item twice by mistake.

IN USE correct a duplicate scan

line item

Individual product entry in a transaction record.

IN USE review the line item

recorded quantity

Number of units entered in the system.

IN USE correct the recorded quantity

physical quantity

Actual number of items the shopper has.

IN USE verify the physical quantity

basket correction

Amendment to the selected goods before completion.

IN USE make a basket correction

void entry

Cancel an incorrect recorded item under the store process.

IN USE void the duplicate entry

quantity adjustment

Change to the number of units recorded.

IN USE confirm the quantity adjustment

revised total

Updated amount after a correction.

IN USE read back the revised total

amount due

Sum still to be paid.

IN USE confirm the amount due

Precision check

The original record incorrectly shows two \$8 mugs, totaling \$16. The corrected record shows one \$8 mug. This is a quantity correction before payment, not a refund of money already taken.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

payment status

Stage of the payment, such as unstarted or completed.

IN USE check the payment status

tender

Money or payment method offered to pay.

IN USE confirm the tender amount

cash payment

Payment made using notes or coins.

IN USE process a cash payment

card terminal

Device used for supported card-payment interactions.

IN USE identify the card terminal

contactless payment

Payment interaction using supported contactless technology.

IN USE distinguish a contactless payment

authorization

Payment-system approval stage, not equivalent to every later settlement step.

IN USE check authorization status

declined payment

Payment attempt not approved through the relevant system.

IN USE explain a declined payment

receipt

Record of a transaction or completed purchase details.

IN USE check the receipt

refund

Return of money already paid.

IN USE distinguish a refund from a correction

change

Cash returned when the tendered amount exceeds the amount due.

IN USE confirm the change

customer display

Screen showing transaction information to the shopper.

IN USE check the customer display

transaction completion

Finalizing the sale through the actual store process.

IN USE confirm transaction completion

Precision check

A displayed total, a started payment, an authorization, and a completed transaction are different states. In this case payment has not begun, so do not invent a decline, reversal, or refund. Follow the actual checkout process for the correction.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE DUPLICATE

"You are right; the mug has been recorded twice."

PAUSE BEFORE PAYMENT

"Let us correct the basket before payment begins."

NAME THE CORRECTION

"I will correct the recorded quantity through our checkout process."

READ BACK THE AMOUNT

"The corrected total is \$8."

STATE THE ACTUAL QUANTITY

"You have one mug, not two."

EXPLAIN THE RECORD

"The current entry shows two at \$8, totaling \$16."

CONFIRM THE REVISED QUANTITY

"The record now shows one mug."

KEEP STATUS CLEAR

"Payment has not begun."

Twice versus two

Scanning the same intended item twice does not mean the shopper has two items.

Quantity versus price

The unit price is unchanged; the recorded number of mugs is corrected.

Due versus paid

Eight dollars due is not eight dollars already paid.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID REFUND LANGUAGE

"No money has been taken, so this is not a refund."

DISTINGUISH THE PRICE

"The price per mug stays \$8; the quantity was wrong."

CONFIRM THE REMAINING STEP

"Payment is still the next step."

AVOID AN INVENTED DECLINE

"There has been no payment attempt to decline."

INVITE A CHECK

"Please check that the display shows one mug at \$8."

AVOID A FALSE DISCOUNT

"This is a correction, not a special discount."

KEEP THE EXPLANATION SHORT

"The duplicate is removed; one mug remains."

CLOSE THE CORRECTION

"We have confirmed the corrected basket before proceeding."

Correction versus refund

An unstarted payment has no paid amount to return in this scenario.

Now shows

This describes the updated record, not merely a promise to change it later.

Before proceeding

The shopper can verify the correction before the payment step begins.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which explanation is accurate?

- A** The shopper has two mugs but pays for one.
- B** One mug was recorded twice; the corrected total is \$8 before payment.
- C** The price of each mug has been reduced to \$4.
- D** A \$16 payment has already been refunded.

2. Which term should not describe this correction?

- A** Revised total
- B** Duplicate scan correction
- C** Refund
- D** Quantity adjustment

3. What should the customer display show after correction?

- A** Two mugs at \$8 each
- B** A completed payment receipt
- C** A declined-payment message
- D** One mug at \$8

4. Which statement preserves the final stage?

- A** The bank rejected the payment.
- B** Change has already been returned.
- C** The basket is corrected; payment is still next.
- D** The sale is already paid and complete.

Answers and explanations: [page 82](#).

One mug, two recorded entries

E Conversations / turns 1-10

04

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

payment status / line item / duplicate scan / revised total / physical quantity / customer display / quantity adjustment / amount due / Transaction completion / refund

- 01 **Leo:** Could you check the screen before I pay? It shows two mugs, but I only have one here on the counter.
- 02 **Amira:** You are right. There is a ¹ _____. The mug has been recorded twice, and we should correct that before starting payment.
- 03 **Leo:** I thought it might have scanned while you were moving it, but I mainly want to make sure the quantity matches what I am buying.
- 04 **Amira:** The ² _____ is one mug. The recorded quantity is two, so the issue is the number entered rather than the price of the mug.
- 05 **Leo:** The shelf price was eight dollars. That part still looks right, but the total is sixteen because the entry appears twice.
- 06 **Amira:** Exactly. The ³ _____ needs correction. Two at eight dollars gives sixteen, while your one mug should total eight dollars here.
- 07 **Leo:** Please correct it before I use the payment terminal. I have not started paying yet, and I would prefer to check the amount first.
- 08 **Amira:** The ⁴ _____ is still unstated. I will make the quantity correction through our checkout process before we move to the payment step.
- 09 **Leo:** Does that mean you are changing the price, or just removing the extra recorded mug? I want to understand what will remain on the screen.
- 10 **Amira:** It is a ⁵ _____. The price per mug stays eight dollars; we are removing the extra recorded unit rather than applying a discount.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

04

Continue with the word bank on page 37.

- 11 **Leo:** All right. I can see the quantity has changed to one now. Could you confirm the total as well so I know the correction is complete?
- 12 **Amira:** The ⁶ _____ is eight dollars for one mug. There are no other charges on this purchase, and the basket now matches the item on the counter.
- 13 **Leo:** Thank you. Someone once called a correction like this a refund, which made me wonder whether I had already been charged without realizing it.
- 14 **Amira:** This is not a ⁷ _____. No money has been taken here, so we are correcting the unpaid basket rather than returning a payment.
- 15 **Leo:** That is clear. The difference matters, because I have not presented payment and would not expect a completed transaction yet.
- 16 **Amira:** Correct. The ⁸ _____ is eight dollars. It is still to be paid, and I will not describe the sale as paid or completed.
- 17 **Leo:** The screen is showing one mug and eight dollars, which is what I expected. I am satisfied that the basket itself is right now.
- 18 **Amira:** Thank you for checking the ⁹ _____. Reading back both the quantity and the amount helps confirm that the record and your purchase agree.
- 19 **Leo:** We can move to payment next, then. I appreciate you explaining the correction instead of just changing the number without saying what happened.
- 20 **Amira:** We have confirmed one mug at eight dollars. ¹⁰ _____ is still ahead of us, after the payment step, so the correction has not been confused with a refund or an already finished sale.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 83

1. duplicate scan | 2. physical quantity | 3. line item | 4. payment status | 5. quantity adjustment | 6. revised total | 7. refund | 8. amount due | 9. customer display | 10. Transaction completion

Correct a different duplicate scan

F Say it

One bowl costs \$12, but two were recorded for \$24. The shopper has one bowl. Payment has not begun and no other charges apply. The quantity is corrected to one.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

twelve / one / refund / begun

Cashier: "The actual quantity is ¹ _____ bowl."

Shopper: "The corrected total is ² _____ dollars."

Cashier: "Payment has not ³ _____."

Shopper: "This is a correction, not a ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 83

1. one | 2. twelve | 3. begun | 4. refund

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Eligible does not mean in stock

A Read the situation

Apply supplied exchange conditions while separating eligibility from replacement availability and completed processing.

05

Shopper Morgan wants a larger size of a shirt bought ten days ago. The shirt is unused, its tags remain attached, and Morgan has the receipt. In this fictional store, those conditions permit an exchange within thirty days. Associate Ellis confirms that the supplied conditions are met, then explains that stock of the larger size has not been checked. Morgan wants the same shirt in the larger size, not a different color or an automatic refund. The exchange remains unfinished pending the stock check and actual store process.

PEOPLE / Morgan: Shopper | Ellis: Customer-service associate

EXPLAIN THE POLICY WITHOUT MAKING IT UNIVERSAL

A clear answer can confirm what the supplied store policy allows while admitting that the desired replacement has not yet been located. Do not use eligibility as a promise of immediate stock, and do not substitute a refund or another variation for the shopper's stated request.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which supplied policy conditions are met?

- A** Only the request for a larger size
- B** Unused shirt, attached tags, receipt, and purchase within thirty days
- C** Used shirt without proof of purchase
- D** Purchase outside the stated window

2. What does Morgan want?

- A** An automatic refund
- B** A different color without discussion
- C** A second identical size
- D** The same shirt in a larger size

3. What remains unknown?

- A** Whether ten days is within thirty
- B** Whether the shirt is unused
- C** Larger-size availability
- D** Whether a receipt is present

Answers and explanations: page 84.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

return

Bringing an item back for a requested resolution.

IN USE discuss a return

exchange

Replacing a purchased item with another agreed item.

IN USE request an exchange

refund

Return of money already paid.

IN USE distinguish an exchange from a refund

store credit

Value issued for use with the retailer under stated terms.

IN USE clarify store-credit terms

proof of purchase

Record supporting where and when the item was bought.

IN USE check proof of purchase

receipt

Transaction record supplied as purchase evidence.

IN USE review the receipt

purchase date

Date on which the original sale occurred.

IN USE confirm the purchase date

exchange window

Time period during which the stated exchange policy applies.

IN USE check the exchange window

eligibility

Whether the stated conditions for a process are met.

IN USE confirm exchange eligibility

unused condition

Item state in which it has not been used.

IN USE confirm unused condition

attached tags

Original tags still connected to the item.

IN USE check attached tags

original packaging

Packaging supplied with the original product.

IN USE identify original packaging

Precision check

Ten days is within the fictional thirty-day exchange window, and the unused condition, attached tags, and receipt are present. Eligibility is established on these supplied facts, but availability of the larger size is still unknown.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

replacement size

Different size requested in the exchange.

IN USE check the replacement size

same-style exchange

Exchange retaining the same product style while changing a variation.

IN USE request a same-style exchange

price difference

Difference between original and replacement prices, if established.

IN USE clarify any price difference

policy condition

Requirement stated in the relevant store policy.

IN USE explain a policy condition

exception request

Request for a departure from a stated policy, requiring the relevant authority.

IN USE refer an exception request

manager review

Review by a person with the relevant decision authority.

IN USE arrange manager review

statutory rights

Rights established by applicable law, distinct from a fictional store policy.

IN USE distinguish statutory rights

replacement stock

Inventory of the desired alternative item.

IN USE check replacement stock

availability check

Verification that the exact replacement can be supplied.

IN USE complete the availability check

exchange processing

Store steps needed to carry out an agreed exchange.

IN USE complete exchange processing

requested remedy

Outcome the shopper asks the store to provide.

IN USE confirm the requested remedy

pending exchange

Exchange not yet completed.

IN USE record the pending exchange

Precision check

An exchange, refund, and store credit are different outcomes. The shopper requests the same shirt in a larger size. Do not promise an unverified replacement, invent a price difference, or present the fictional policy as a statement of universal consumer rights.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

CLARIFY THE REQUESTED OUTCOME

"Would you like the same shirt in a larger size?"

STATE THE LOCAL WINDOW

"This store's stated exchange window is thirty days."

IDENTIFY THE EVIDENCE

"You have the receipt as proof of purchase."

SEPARATE STOCK FROM POLICY

"I still need to check the larger size."

CHECK THE DATE

"The receipt shows the purchase was ten days ago."

CONFIRM THE CONDITION

"The shirt is unused and the tags are attached."

CONFIRM ELIGIBILITY

"The supplied conditions for this exchange are met."

AVOID A READINESS PROMISE

"Eligibility does not mean the replacement is already available."

Within

Ten days falls inside the stated thirty-day window.

Eligible versus available

Policy conditions can be met while replacement stock remains unknown.

Same versus similar

The same shirt is more specific than an unrequested similar product.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

KEEP THE VARIATION EXACT

"Same shirt and color, larger size."

KEEP ALTERNATIVES OPTIONAL

"We can discuss alternatives only if you want to."

NAME THE PENDING STEP

"The replacement-stock check is still outstanding."

LIMIT THE POLICY CLAIM

"I am explaining this store's stated policy for this case."

AVOID CHANGING THE REMEDY

"I will not turn your exchange request into a refund without discussion."

AVOID INVENTED CHARGES

"No price difference has been established here."

KEEP THE STATUS ACCURATE

"The exchange has not been completed yet."

CLOSE WITH THE NEXT ACTION

"I will check the exact larger-size replacement next."

Exchange versus refund

Replacing an item and returning money are different remedies.

Present versus processed

Having a receipt does not mean an exchange has already been completed.

Local policy

The exercise policy is a supplied condition, not a replacement for applicable rights.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which explanation is accurate?

- A** A receipt automatically completes the exchange.
- B** You meet the stated exchange conditions; I still need to check the larger size.
- C** Meeting the policy guarantees the replacement is here.
- D** Ten days is outside thirty days.

2. Which outcome has the shopper requested?

- A** Different material selected by staff
- B** Same-shirt exchange to a larger size
- C** Immediate store credit instead
- D** Refund without further discussion

3. Which claim is unsupported?

- A** The larger size is unchecked.
- B** Every store must use this exact thirty-day policy.
- C** The receipt is present.
- D** The tags remain attached.

4. What should be checked next?

- A** A refund already described as complete
- B** Stock of the exact larger-size replacement
- C** Whether ten is greater than thirty
- D** An unrelated color chosen without asking

Answers and explanations: [page 84](#).

Eligible does not mean in stock

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

05

WORD + PHRASE BANK

requested remedy / refund / exchange window / replacement size / availability check / proof of purchase / exchange / Replacement stock / eligibility / pending exchange

- 01 **Morgan:** I bought this shirt ten days ago, and I would like a larger size. It has not been used, and I have kept the tags attached.
- 02 **Ellis:** I can help check the ¹ _____ request. Do you want the same shirt and color, with only the size changed?
- 03 **Morgan:** Yes, exactly the same shirt. I do not want another color substituted just because it might be easier to find.
- 04 **Ellis:** I will keep the ² _____ separate from the other details. The request is the same shirt and color in the larger size.
- 05 **Morgan:** Here is the receipt. I was not sure whether ten days was still inside the period for an exchange at this store.
- 06 **Ellis:** Our stated ³ _____ is thirty days for an unused shirt with attached tags and a receipt. Ten days falls within that period.
- 07 **Morgan:** The shirt is unused, and the tags are still on it. Is there another condition in the policy you have just described that I am missing?
- 08 **Ellis:** On these facts, the ⁴ _____ conditions are met. That answers the policy question, but I still need to check the larger-size stock.
- 09 **Morgan:** So I qualify for the exchange, but you are not yet saying that the replacement is definitely here today.
- 10 **Ellis:** Correct. ⁵ _____ has not been checked. I do not want the policy confirmation to sound like a promise that we have located your size.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 46.

- 11 **Morgan:** Thank you. I would prefer that distinction now rather than expect to walk out with it before anyone has looked.
- 12 **Ellis:** The ⁶ _____ is the next step. We will use the same shirt and color in the larger size, rather than check only for something similar.
- 13 **Morgan:** If it is not available, I would want to hear the options before making another choice. Please do not automatically refund it.
- 14 **Ellis:** I will preserve your ⁷ _____. You have asked for an exchange, and any different outcome should be discussed with you instead of assumed.
- 15 **Morgan:** Good. I have had refund and exchange used as though they meant the same thing, which can be confusing at the counter.
- 16 **Ellis:** A ⁸ _____ returns money, while an exchange replaces the item with an agreed alternative. They are different outcomes, even when both begin with bringing an item back.
- 17 **Morgan:** That makes sense. Does having the receipt here mean the exchange itself is already processed, or is it simply the evidence for the original purchase?
- 18 **Ellis:** It is ⁹ _____. The receipt supports the original transaction and date, but the replacement and exchange processing are not complete.
- 19 **Morgan:** Then please check the larger size next. The same shirt is still my first choice, and I understand we do not have a stock answer yet.
- 20 **Ellis:** I will do that. The status is a ¹⁰ _____: the stated conditions are met, the requested replacement is clear, and stock and processing remain to be confirmed.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 85

1. exchange | 2. replacement size | 3. exchange window | 4. eligibility | 5. Replacement stock | 6. availability check | 7. requested remedy | 8. refund | 9. proof of purchase | 10. pending exchange

Separate another eligibility and stock question

F Say it

A fictional store permits unused, tagged shirts to be exchanged with a receipt within twenty-one days. A shopper bought a shirt seven days ago, meets those conditions, and requests the same shirt in small. Replacement stock is unchecked.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

small / within / unchecked / exchange

Associate: "Seven days is ¹ _____ the stated window."

Shopper: "The replacement size requested is ² _____."

Associate: "Replacement stock remains ³ _____."

Shopper: "The requested remedy is an ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 85

1. within | 2. small | 3. unchecked | 4. exchange

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

An order message is not a pickup notice

A Read the situation

Distinguish order acknowledgment from collection readiness and give a reliable update commitment without promising an outcome.

Shopper Ravi shows collection-desk associate Jules a message acknowledging order R61. It is not a ready-for-collection notification. One item is still being located, and the complete order is not confirmed ready. Collection colleague Noor will update Ravi at 3:00 even if the issue is unresolved. No substitute size, color, or product has been agreed. Jules must keep the order reference, current status, next contact owner, and update time clear without turning 3:00 into a collection promise.

PEOPLE / Ravi: Shopper | Jules: Collection-desk associate

06

AN UPDATE IS STILL USEFUL WHEN THE OUTCOME IS UNCERTAIN

A shopper may read a positive-sounding automated message as permission to travel to the store. Explain what the message actually confirms, acknowledge the inconvenience, and state who will update them and when. Do not make the uncertainty disappear by offering a guessed ready time.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What does the message confirm?

- A Collection has already occurred
- C The complete order is ready to collect

- B Acknowledgment of order R61
- D A substitute has been accepted

2. What remains unfinished?

- A A refund is already processed
- C Every item has been collected

- B One item is still being located
- D The shopper has accepted another color

3. What is promised for 3:00?

- A Guaranteed collection readiness
- C A completed refund

- B Automatic replacement with another size
- D An update from Noor, even if unresolved

Answers and explanations: page 86.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

order acknowledgment

Message confirming that an order has been received or recorded.

IN USE read the order acknowledgment

order reference

Identifier used to locate the specific order.

IN USE confirm the order reference

collection notice

Message stating that the order can be collected under the stated process.

IN USE distinguish a collection notice

pickup

Common US term for collecting an order.

IN USE explain pickup status

ready for collection

Status indicating the relevant preparation and checks are complete.

IN USE confirm ready-for-collection status

order line

Individual item entry within an order.

IN USE check the outstanding order line

item location

Place where a requested unit is being found or verified.

IN USE confirm the item location

picking

Selecting the ordered goods from stock under the store process.

IN USE check picking status

packing

Preparing selected goods for handover or dispatch.

IN USE distinguish packing from picking

fulfillment

Process of preparing and supplying the order.

IN USE explain fulfillment status

partial order

Order for which only some items are available or prepared.

IN USE describe a partial order

complete order

All items included in the order together.

IN USE verify the complete order

Precision check

Order R61 is acknowledged but not confirmed ready. One item is still being located. Noor will update the shopper at 3:00 even if unresolved; that is an update commitment, not a promise that collection will be possible then.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

collection desk

Store point handling order pickup.

IN USE contact the collection desk

collection colleague

Staff member responsible for the relevant pickup update.

IN USE name the collection colleague

status update

Communication about the latest verified position.

IN USE give a status update

update deadline

Time by which an update will be provided.

IN USE confirm the update deadline

readiness estimate

Provisional expectation of when collection may be possible.

IN USE distinguish a readiness estimate

readiness promise

Commitment that the order will be available by a stated time.

IN USE avoid an unsupported readiness promise

unresolved item

Item whose location or status remains unsettled.

IN USE track the unresolved item

variation match

Confirmation that size, color, and other details match the order.

IN USE check the variation match

substitution consent

Shopper agreement to a different item or variation.

IN USE obtain substitution consent

contact owner

Person responsible for the next communication.

IN USE identify the contact owner

collection record

Record of order preparation and handover status.

IN USE update the collection record

handover completion

Actual transfer of the order to the shopper.

IN USE confirm handover completion

Precision check

A different size, color, or product is not automatically an acceptable way to complete the order. No substitution is agreed. Keep preparation, readiness, and actual handover distinct so a message does not imply a stage that has not occurred.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

IDENTIFY THE ORDER

"Let us check order R61."

EXPLAIN THE MESSAGE

"This is an order acknowledgment, not a collection notice."

06

STATE THE CURRENT POSITION

"One item is still being located."

AVOID A READINESS CLAIM

"The complete order is not confirmed ready yet."

ACKNOWLEDGE THE INCONVENIENCE

"I understand why you expected the message to mean you could collect it."

NAME THE UPDATE OWNER

"Noor is the collection colleague handling the next update."

GIVE THE CONTACT TIME

"Noor will update you at 3:00."

KEEP THE COMMITMENT PRECISE

"The update will happen even if the issue is still unresolved."

Acknowledged versus ready

Recording an order does not establish that every item is prepared for collection.

At three versus by three

Here at three identifies the promised contact time, not an order-completion deadline.

Even if

This keeps the communication commitment valid when the outcome remains uncertain.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

SEPARATE TIME AND OUTCOME

"Three o'clock is the update time, not a guaranteed collection time."

AVOID AN UNREQUESTED SUBSTITUTE

"No alternative item has been agreed."

DO NOT INVENT A CAUSE

"I do not have a confirmed reason the item has not been located."

KEEP HANDOVER STATUS ACCURATE

"The order has not been collected."

PRESERVE THE ORDERED VARIATION

"We will keep the requested size and color in the check."

ASK BEFORE A CHANGE

"Any proposed substitution needs your agreement."

READ BACK THE NEXT STEP

"Noor will provide the next status update at 3:00."

CLOSE WITH THE KNOWN FACTS

"Acknowledged order, one unresolved item, next update at three."

Complete order

Readiness of some items does not establish readiness of the whole order.

Substitute

A different variation requires discussion instead of silent acceptance on the shopper's behalf.

Located versus handed over

Finding an item is a different stage from transferring the order to the shopper.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

06

1. Which explanation is accurate?

- A** The order has already been collected.
- B** The message acknowledges R61; one item is still being located.
- C** Every acknowledged order is ready.
- D** The shopper accepted a substitute by showing the message.

2. What does even if unresolved add?

- A** A substitute will be selected automatically.
- B** The shopper loses the right to ask questions.
- C** The update still occurs without a final stock answer.
- D** The order must be ready by then.

3. Which statement wrongly turns an update into a promise?

- A** Your complete order will definitely be ready at 3:00.
- B** Noor will update you at 3:00.
- C** One item is still being located.
- D** No substitute has been agreed.

4. What needs separate agreement?

- A** A proposed different size, color, or product
- B** Reading the order reference aloud in the conversation
- C** Stating that readiness is unconfirmed
- D** Naming the update time

Answers and explanations: page 86.

An order message is not a pickup notice

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

order line / substitution consent / order acknowledgment / variation match / status update / order reference / Handover completion / contact owner / update deadline / item location

06

- 01 **Ravi:** I received this message about order R61, so I came to collect it. It says you have my order, but the desk cannot find everything yet.
- 02 **Jules:** Let me clarify the ¹ _____. This message confirms the order was received; it is not the notice saying the complete order is ready to collect.
- 03 **Ravi:** I see the difference now, although the wording sounded positive enough that I thought I could come in. What is the current position?
- 04 **Jules:** One ² _____ is still being located. I cannot confirm the complete order is ready while that item remains unresolved.
- 05 **Ravi:** Does that mean you know it is sold out, or simply that someone has not located the correct item yet?
- 06 **Jules:** The confirmed fact is the unfinished ³ _____ check. I should not turn that into a sold-out claim or invent a reason that has not been verified.
- 07 **Ravi:** Thank you. Can someone tell me when I will hear more? I do not want to keep coming back to the desk for the same answer.
- 08 **Jules:** Noor is the ⁴ _____ for the next update. Noor will update you at three o'clock, including if the item is still unresolved.
- 09 **Ravi:** So I will hear from Noor at three even if there is not a final answer. That would at least let me plan what to do next.
- 10 **Jules:** Yes. The ⁵ _____ is the commitment. You should not have to infer from silence whether the check is still continuing.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 55.

- 11 **Ravi:** I want to be careful about the time. Are you promising the order will be ready at three, or only that I will get an update then?
- 12 **Jules:** Three is the ⁶ _____, not a guaranteed collection time. We have not established when the complete order will be ready.
- 13 **Ravi:** Understood. Please do not replace the missing item with another size or color just to make the order look complete.
- 14 **Jules:** No ⁷ _____ has been given. Any proposed alternative needs a separate discussion with you rather than being treated as an automatic solution.
- 15 **Ravi:** The exact version matters because the item is a gift. I would rather receive a clear update than collect the wrong variation.
- 16 **Jules:** We will keep the ⁸ _____ in the check. Finding something similar is not the same as confirming the item you ordered.
- 17 **Ravi:** Could you repeat the reference and the next step? I want to make sure this update is attached to my order, not another one.
- 18 **Jules:** The ⁹ _____ is R61. One item is still being located, and Noor will update you at three even if that remains unresolved.
- 19 **Ravi:** That is clear. I have not collected the order, and I should wait for an actual collection notification rather than rely on the acknowledgment.
- 20 **Jules:** Correct. ¹⁰ _____ has not happened. The current record should preserve the unconfirmed readiness and the next update, without describing the order as already collected.

06

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 87

1. order acknowledgment | 2. order line | 3. item location | 4. contact owner | 5. status update | 6. update deadline | 7. substitution consent | 8. variation match | 9. order reference | 10. Handover completion

Keep another update commitment precise

F Say it

Order P74 is acknowledged but not ready for collection because one item is still being located. Jo will update the shopper at 4:30 even if unresolved. No substitution is agreed.

06

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

4:30 / Jo / P74 / agreed

Associate: "The order reference is ¹ _____."

Shopper: "The next update is at ² _____."

Associate: "The update owner is ³ _____."

Shopper: "No substitution has been ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 87

1. P74 | 2. 4:30 | 3. Jo | 4. agreed

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A checkout route that works

A Read the situation

Ask what assistance is preferred, offer an available checkout route, and respect individual choices and position in line.

Shopper Sam uses a mobility aid and says the current checkout is too narrow. Associate Lina knows that accessible checkout lane four is open, reached by the clear main aisle to the left. Sam prefers spoken directions, keeps personal belongings and the mobility aid under their own control, and accepts the move to lane four. Lina will ask colleague Noor to preserve the current place in line during the move; that request is not yet confirmed. No diagnosis, physical assistance, or handling of belongings is requested.

PEOPLE / Sam: Shopper | Lina: Retail associate

07

ASK RATHER THAN TAKE OVER

Address the shopper directly and ask what help would be useful. A mobility aid is not an invitation to touch it or a reason to make assumptions about the person. Give practical information and respect the requested form of assistance without demanding a personal explanation.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What problem does Sam identify?

- A Every checkout is inaccessible
- C The shopper forgot a payment card

- B The current checkout is too narrow
- D The store is closed

2. Which available route is offered?

- A An unverified staff-only shortcut
- C A closed lane with no clear route

- B Main aisle to the left toward open lane four
- D Moving the mobility aid without asking

3. What help does Sam prefer?

- A Staff taking the mobility aid
- C Spoken directions, with belongings and aid left under personal control

- B A medical assessment
- D Unrequested physical guidance

Answers and explanations: [page 88](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

queue

Line of shoppers waiting for service.

IN USE manage the queue

place in line

Shopper's position in the service order.

IN USE preserve a place in line

checkout lane

Specific path and counter used for payment.

IN USE identify the checkout lane

accessible checkout

Checkout identified as accessible in the supplied store scenario.

IN USE offer the accessible checkout

main aisle

Principal route through the selling area.

IN USE describe the main aisle

clear route

Route free of the stated obstruction in the scenario.

IN USE identify a clear route

narrow passage

Space the shopper reports as too restricted for access.

IN USE acknowledge a narrow passage

mobility aid

Device a person uses to support movement.

IN USE respect the mobility aid

walker

Walking aid providing support through a frame.

IN USE identify a walker when relevant

wheelchair

Mobility device used for seated movement.

IN USE respect wheelchair users' choices

personal belongings

Items owned or carried by the shopper.

IN USE ask before handling belongings

preferred assistance

Help the shopper says would be useful.

IN USE ask about preferred assistance

Precision check

Lane four is open and reached by the supplied main-aisle route. Sam chooses spoken directions and retains control of belongings and the mobility aid. Lina will ask Noor to preserve the place in line, but that coordination is not yet confirmed.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

spoken directions

Verbal explanation of where to go.

IN USE offer spoken directions

physical guidance

Hands-on assistance, not authorized by a general offer to help.

IN USE ask before physical guidance

permission

Agreement to a specific action.

IN USE obtain permission before handling items

independent movement

Shopper moving under their own control.

IN USE respect independent movement

direct address

Speaking to the shopper rather than only a companion.

IN USE use direct address

companion

Person accompanying the shopper, not automatically their spokesperson.

IN USE avoid addressing only the companion

route confirmation

Check that the proposed path is understood and suitable for the request.

IN USE give a route confirmation

colleague coordination

Communication to arrange the next service step with another worker.

IN USE coordinate with a colleague

open lane

Checkout currently available for use.

IN USE identify the open lane

queue transfer

Move between lines while managing the service order.

IN USE arrange a queue transfer

assistance boundary

Limit on what help the shopper has authorized.

IN USE respect the assistance boundary

pending request

Asked-for action not yet confirmed or completed.

IN USE distinguish a pending request

Precision check

Do not turn a helpful offer into unrequested touching or a medical inquiry. Ask about the practical assistance needed for this route. The fictional description identifies an available checkout; it does not certify real-world accessibility or replace applicable requirements.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE BARRIER

"I understand that this checkout is too narrow for you."

OFFER THE AVAILABLE LANE

"The accessible checkout at lane four is open."

CHECK THE PREFERENCE

"Would spoken directions be helpful?"

RESPECT THE MOBILITY AID

"I will leave your mobility aid under your control."

ASK ABOUT PREFERRED HELP

"What help would you prefer?"

DESCRIBE THE ROUTE

"The clear main aisle to the left leads to lane four."

RESPECT BELONGINGS

"I will not handle your belongings without your permission."

AVOID A PERSONAL INQUIRY

"We can focus on the checkout route and the help you want."

Would you like

Offers a choice without assuming that assistance is needed or wanted.

Directly

Speaking to the shopper preserves agency even when a companion is present.

Permission scope

Accepting directions does not authorize touching a bag or mobility aid.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

ADDRESS THE SHOPPER

"Let me check the next step with you directly."

KEEP COORDINATION ACCURATE

"That request still needs confirmation."

CONFIRM THE ACCEPTED HELP

"You prefer directions, without physical assistance."

KEEP THE CHOICE WITH THE SHOPPER

"Please tell me if you prefer a different form of help."

PRESERVE SERVICE ORDER

"I will ask Noor to preserve your place during the move."

AVOID AN UNVERIFIED PROMISE

"I have not yet confirmed the queue arrangement with Noor."

INVITE A ROUTE QUESTION

"Is there any part of the route you would like clarified?"

CLOSE THE ARRANGEMENT

"Lane four is available; I will coordinate the place-in-line request."

Too narrow

This reports the shopper's practical barrier without requiring a diagnosis.

Will ask versus confirmed

A promised coordination step is not proof that the colleague has accepted it.

Preserve versus restart

Preserving the place means addressing continuity rather than automatically sending the shopper to the back.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which opening respects the shopper's choice?

- A** Tell me your diagnosis before I help.
- B** Your companion should decide for you.
- C** What help would you prefer with the route to lane four?
- D** I will move your aid now.

2. Which action is authorized?

- A** Giving spoken directions
- B** Taking the mobility aid without asking
- C** Carrying the bag despite refusal
- D** Providing hands-on guidance automatically

3. Which statement accurately describes the queue arrangement?

- A** The request is completed because Lina thought of it.
- B** Lina will ask Noor to preserve the place; confirmation is pending.
- C** Noor has already confirmed the move.
- D** Sam must automatically restart at the back.

4. Which route information is supplied?

- A** A closed lane at the far exit
- B** A measured legal clearance for every passage
- C** Clear main aisle to the left, toward open lane four
- D** An unverified back-room shortcut

Answers and explanations: [page 88](#).

A checkout route that works

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

spoken directions / main aisle / place in line / route confirmation / assistance boundary / accessible checkout / direct address / pending request / colleague coordination / permission

07

- 01 **Sam:** This checkout is too narrow for me to get through comfortably with my mobility aid. Is there another lane I can use?
- 02 **Lina:** Yes. The ¹ _____ at lane four is open. Before I offer help, what would you prefer?
- 03 **Sam:** Directions would be enough. I can move myself, and I would like to keep my bag and mobility aid with me.
- 04 **Lina:** I will give ² _____ and leave your belongings and aid under your control. I will not assume you want me to carry or move anything.
- 05 **Sam:** Thank you. Where is lane four from here? I cannot see the lane number clearly past the people standing in this line.
- 06 **Lina:** The ³ _____ to your left leads toward lane four. That is the clear route available, rather than trying to continue through this narrow checkout.
- 07 **Sam:** That sounds workable. I am also concerned about losing my place, because I have already been waiting here for some time.
- 08 **Lina:** I will ask Noor to preserve your ⁴ _____ during the move. I do not want to treat the change of lane as a reason to ignore the time you have already waited.
- 09 **Sam:** Has Noor agreed to that already, or is it something you still need to arrange? I would like to know the current position.
- 10 **Lina:** The ⁵ _____ still needs confirmation. I will ask Noor, but I should not tell you the arrangement has already been accepted.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 64.

- 11 **Sam:** I appreciate that distinction. Please ask, and keep the directions as the help I have chosen. I do not need someone to move the aid.
- 12 **Lina:** Understood. Your ⁶ _____ is clear. Directions are welcome; touching the mobility aid or taking your bag has not been authorized.
- 13 **Sam:** Exactly. Sometimes people begin helping before asking, and then I have to stop them while also trying to navigate the space.
- 14 **Lina:** I will seek ⁷ _____ before any different kind of help. Your answer about directions should not be treated as agreement to every possible action.
- 15 **Sam:** Good. I am happy to move to lane four using the route you described once the place-in-line request has been checked.
- 16 **Lina:** Let me give a ⁸ _____: use the clear main aisle to the left, toward the open lane four. I will also follow up with Noor about the queue.
- 17 **Sam:** That is clear. There is no need to ask my companion to decide; I can explain what assistance works for me.
- 18 **Lina:** Of course. I will use ⁹ _____ and keep discussing the arrangement with you. The practical route and your preference are what we need to clarify.
- 19 **Sam:** Thank you. Directions, no handling of my belongings or aid, and a request to preserve my place are the help I am asking for.
- 20 **Lina:** That is accurate. The ¹⁰ _____ is the queue arrangement with Noor. Lane four is open, your preferred assistance is clear, and I will not describe the coordination as complete until it is confirmed.

07

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 89

1. accessible checkout | 2. spoken directions | 3. main aisle | 4. place in line | 5. colleague coordination | 6. assistance boundary | 7. permission | 8. route confirmation | 9. direct address | 10. pending request

Offer another agreed form of help

F Say it

A shopper says lane two is too narrow. Open lane six is reached through the clear aisle to the right. The shopper wants spoken directions only. A request to preserve the place in line is awaiting a colleague response.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

07

WORD + PHRASE BANK

six / directions / right / pending

Associate: "The open alternative is lane ¹ _____."

Shopper: "The clear aisle is to the ² _____."

Associate: "The preferred help is spoken ³ _____."

Shopper: "The place-in-line request is still ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 89

1. six | 2. right | 3. directions | 4. pending

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Five dollars below the expected count

A Read the situation

Report an unverified cash difference neutrally and transfer ownership of two unfinished checks without inventing a cause.

At shift change, cashier Tessa reports an expected drawer balance of \$180 and a recorded count of \$175. A second check has not occurred, so the recorded difference is \$5 below expected with no cause established. A separate price query for item P32 is also open. Incoming supervisor Arun accepts responsibility for both the second balance check and the P32 price query. Neither task is completed during the handover. Tessa must not accuse a colleague, describe a proven loss, or imply that Arun accepting the checks resolves them.

08

PEOPLE / Tessa: Outgoing cashier | Arun: Incoming supervisor

NEUTRAL DETAIL IS STRONGER THAN SUSPICION

A precise handover names the expected figure, the recorded count, the unchecked difference, and the person taking the next action. It should not speculate about a colleague or combine unrelated open matters into an invented explanation. Separate ownership from completion.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is the recorded difference?

- A \$5 below expected
- C \$175 below expected

- B \$5 above expected
- D No difference

2. What verification is pending?

- A A confirmed theft finding
- C A second balance check

- B An approved correction to P32
- D A completed investigation

3. What does Arun accept?

- A Only a resolved price query
- C Both unfinished checks, not their completed outcomes

- B Responsibility for an admitted cause
- D A proven-loss finding

Answers and explanations: page 90.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

till

Register or cash-handling point used for sales.

IN USE hand over the till

cash drawer

Compartment holding cash at the checkout.

IN USE check the cash drawer

expected balance

Amount the relevant record indicates should be present.

IN USE state the expected balance

recorded count

Amount entered after the initial cash count.

IN USE report the recorded count

cash difference

Difference between expected and recorded amounts before cause is established.

IN USE report the cash difference

variance

Difference between a reference figure and an actual or recorded figure.

IN USE quantify the variance

overage

Amount recorded above the expected balance.

IN USE distinguish an overage

shortfall

Amount recorded below a specified expected balance.

IN USE describe a recorded shortfall

recount

Another count to verify the initial result.

IN USE request a recount

second check

Independent or repeated verification under the store process.

IN USE complete the second check

reconciliation

Comparison of related records and amounts to explain differences.

IN USE begin reconciliation

opening float

Cash amount assigned at the start for normal checkout operations.

IN USE verify the opening float

Precision check

The arithmetic is \$180 expected minus \$175 recorded, giving \$5 below expected. The second check is pending and the cause is unknown. This is a recorded discrepancy, not proof of theft, a specific error, or a confirmed loss.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

cash drop

Recorded movement of cash out of a till under store procedures.

IN USE check the cash-drop record

cash movement

Transfer of cash that should be reflected in relevant records.

IN USE review cash movements

denomination

Face-value category of notes or coins.

IN USE check the denomination totals

count sheet

Record used to document counted amounts.

IN USE review the count sheet

transaction log

Record of sales and related checkout actions.

IN USE consult the transaction log

unverified discrepancy

Difference not yet confirmed or explained through the required checks.

IN USE record an unverified discrepancy

established cause

Explanation supported by completed verification.

IN USE distinguish an established cause

proven loss

Confirmed loss, not established by the initial difference alone.

IN USE avoid claiming a proven loss

open price query

Unresolved question about an item's price.

IN USE hand over the open price query

incoming supervisor

Supervisor taking over responsibility for the next shift.

IN USE brief the incoming supervisor

action owner

Person assigned the next check or follow-up.

IN USE name the action owner

handover status

Current state of each item at transfer.

IN USE confirm the handover status

Precision check

The P32 price query is a separate unfinished item. No evidence links it to the drawer difference. Arun accepts both follow-ups, but acceptance does not complete the recount or resolve the price question. Record both statuses explicitly.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

STATE THE EXPECTED FIGURE

"The expected drawer balance is \$180."

QUANTIFY THE DIFFERENCE

"That is \$5 below expected."

AVOID A CAUSE CLAIM

"The cause is not established."

AVOID A PROVEN-LOSS STATEMENT

"The initial difference does not establish a confirmed loss."

STATE THE RECORDED FIGURE

"The recorded count is \$175."

MARK THE VERIFICATION STAGE

"The second check has not occurred yet."

KEEP THE LANGUAGE NEUTRAL

"I am reporting a discrepancy, not accusing anyone."

SEPARATE THE OTHER ITEM

"There is also an open price query for P32."

08

Below versus above

The direction of the difference matters as much as the five-dollar amount.

Recorded versus verified

A written initial count can still await the required second check.

Unknown versus suspicious

Unknown cause is a factual limit, not evidence against a person.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID AN INVENTED LINK

"I have no verified connection between the two issues."

CONFIRM OWNERSHIP

"I accept responsibility for both follow-ups."

ASK FOR A READ-BACK

"Please repeat the figures and the two pending actions."

NAME THE CURRENT STATUS

"Recount pending; price query open; cause unknown."

ASSIGN BOTH CHECKS

"Can you take the balance check and the P32 follow-up?"

KEEP COMPLETION SEPARATE

"Neither check is completed by this handover."

PRESERVE THE INITIAL RECORD

"Keep the recorded count distinct from any later verified result."

CLOSE THE HANDOVER

"The next owner is clear, while both outcomes remain unresolved."

08

Also

This introduces a separate item without claiming it caused the first issue.

Accept versus complete

Taking responsibility for a task does not mean it has been performed.

Initial versus final

Preserve the original count while documenting any later checked result accurately.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which handover is accurate?

- A** The drawer is five dollars over.
- B** The second check proved the initial count correct.
- C** Expected \$180, recorded \$175, second check pending, cause unknown.
- D** Five dollars has definitely been stolen.

2. What is known about P32?

- A** Its price query is still open.
- B** It caused the drawer difference.
- C** It has been resolved and closed.
- D** The shopper admitted a pricing error.

3. Which statement wrongly treats ownership as completion?

- A** The second check remains pending.
- B** No cause is established.
- C** Arun accepted both checks, so both issues are resolved.
- D** Arun is the next action owner.

4. Which calculation matches the facts?

- A** The \$175 count is itself the discrepancy.
- B** \$180 minus \$175 equals \$5 below expected.
- C** \$175 minus \$180 means \$5 above expected.
- D** \$180 plus \$175 equals the loss.

Answers and explanations: page 90.

Five dollars below the expected count

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

second check / expected balance / unverified discrepancy / reconciliation / action owner / handover status / recorded count / open price query / variance / proven loss

08

- 01 **Tessa:** Before I finish, I need to hand over the drawer figures and one unfinished price question. Neither issue has had its follow-up check yet.
- 02 **Arun:** Start with the ¹ _____. I want the reference figure and the actual recorded count separately before we describe the difference.
- 03 **Tessa:** The expected balance is one hundred eighty dollars. The count entered on the sheet is one hundred seventy-five dollars, and it has not been checked again.
- 04 **Arun:** Then the ² _____ is one hundred seventy-five. We should preserve that as the initial entry while the required second check remains outstanding.
- 05 **Tessa:** That makes it five dollars below expected. I do not know whether another check or a record review will explain the difference.
- 06 **Arun:** We can report the ³ _____ as five dollars below expected, with no established cause. The arithmetic is clear even though the explanation is not.
- 07 **Tessa:** I have not accused anyone or described it as stolen. I only want the next person to know exactly what needs verification.
- 08 **Arun:** That is appropriate. This is an ⁴ _____, not a finding about a person. We should not turn an incomplete check into an allegation.
- 09 **Tessa:** The other matter is the price query for item P32. That question is still open, and I have no evidence connecting it to the drawer figures.
- 10 **Arun:** I will keep the ⁵ _____ separate. An unfinished question about P32 does not automatically explain the cash difference just because both appear in the handover.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 73.

- 11 **Tessa:** Can you take responsibility for the second balance check and the price follow-up? I do not want either item to be left without an owner.
- 12 **Arun:** Yes. I will be the ⁶ _____ for both. I accept the second balance check and the P32 follow-up, while keeping their outcomes unresolved for now.
- 13 **Tessa:** Thank you. Please make sure the record still says the second check has not occurred. Your accepting it should not make that status disappear.
- 14 **Arun:** The ⁷ _____ remains pending. The handover assigns the work; it does not count as performing it or confirming the first result.
- 15 **Tessa:** Exactly. I also want to avoid writing loss confirmed when all we currently have is the initial difference between those two figures.
- 16 **Arun:** A ⁸ _____ has not been established. The accurate statement is a recorded five-dollar difference with verification pending and the cause unknown.
- 17 **Tessa:** Could you read back both tasks and the figures before I leave? That will help us catch a reversed number or a missing follow-up.
- 18 **Arun:** Expected one hundred eighty, recorded one hundred seventy-five, five below expected. The ⁹ _____ is second check pending and P32 price query open, with me responsible for both follow-ups.
- 19 **Tessa:** That is correct. There is no established cause and no confirmed connection between the price question and the drawer difference.
- 20 **Arun:** I will keep the ¹⁰ _____ work separate from assumptions. Both actions have an owner now, but neither outcome is complete or proved by this conversation.

08

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 91

1. expected balance | 2. recorded count | 3. variance | 4. unverified discrepancy | 5. open price query | 6. action owner | 7. second check | 8. proven loss | 9. handover status | 10. reconciliation

Report a different recorded difference

F Say it

Expected drawer balance is \$240 and the recorded count is \$245. A second check is pending and the cause is unknown. Price query Q18 is open. Supervisor Jo accepts both follow-ups.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

above / unknown / Q18 / pending

08

Cashier: "The recorded count is five dollars ¹ _____ expected."

Supervisor: "The second check is ² _____."

Cashier: "The open price query is ³ _____."

Supervisor: "The cause remains ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 91

1. above | 2. pending | 3. Q18 | 4. unknown

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

01 Briefing and language checks

Finding the item the shopper actually means

A Briefing checks / page 4

1. Which product does Casey mean?

B. Cotton C218

Casey identifies the cotton version, whose reference is C218.

2. Which size is requested?

B. Medium

Medium is the explicit size preference and should not be substituted without agreement.

3. What is known about local stock?

D. It has not been checked

The conversation identifies the item before any local availability check has occurred.

D Language checks / page 9

1. Which read-back is accurate?

A. Blue cotton C218 in medium.

The correct read-back preserves the requested reference, material, color, and size.

2. Which stock statement is supported?

B. Local availability has not been checked yet.

No stock inquiry result exists yet, so both availability and reservation claims are unsupported.

3. Which next step follows the clarification?

B. Check the exact requested variation.

The exact item must be checked before discussing verified local availability.

4. Which distinction should a colleague receive?

A. C218 is cotton; L214 is linen.

The two references identify different products despite their shared color.

01 Conversation answers

Finding the item the shopper actually means

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 10-11

- 1. item reference.** Turn 2. Item reference distinguishes the two advertised products, preventing the shared color from being treated as enough identification.
- 2. cotton.** Turn 4. Cotton identifies the requested material and connects the shopper's choice to C218 rather than the linen item.
- 3. size.** Turn 6. Size is medium, a specific part of the request that should not be replaced with another available size without agreement.
- 4. advertised item.** Turn 8. Advertised item means the product featured in the promotion; it does not prove that the requested variation is available at this branch.
- 5. product variation.** Turn 10. Product variation combines the relevant details, here the blue cotton C218 in medium, which must stay together in the stock inquiry.
- 6. local availability.** Turn 12. Local availability concerns the exact requested item at this branch, not general availability elsewhere or an unrequested substitute.
- 7. reservation.** Turn 14. Reservation would be a confirmed hold under the store process; none has been made during this identification conversation.
- 8. specification.** Turn 16. Specification summarizes the shopper's exact choice: blue cotton C218, medium, with local stock still unchecked.
- 9. substitution.** Turn 18. Substitution changes the requested item or variation and needs the shopper's agreement rather than an assumption of equivalence.
- 10. stock inquiry.** Turn 20. Stock inquiry checks availability after the exact product is identified; its outcome has not yet established available, sold out, or reserved status.

F Transfer conversation

Page 12

1. C314

Associate: "The requested reference is C314."

C314 identifies the cotton sweater the shopper selects, not the wool alternative.

2. large

Shopper: "The requested size is large."

Large is the explicit size choice in this new scenario.

3. unchecked

Associate: "Local stock remains unchecked."

Identifying the product does not supply a verified availability result.

4. reserved

Shopper: "Nothing has been reserved."

No hold has been created merely by clarifying the product request.



02 Briefing and language checks

Comparing fit, materials, and label information

A Briefing checks / page 13

1. Which jacket meets the stated machine-washing requirement?

D. A, according to its label

Jacket A's label permits machine washing, while B's says dry-clean only.

2. What do the two jackets cost?

C. \$60 each

The brief prices each jacket at sixty dollars, not both together.

3. What is unverified?

A. Fit, comfort, and durability

No fitting, comfort evidence, or durability testing has been supplied.

D Language checks / page 18

1. Which recommendation uses the supplied evidence?

A. A meets your machine-washing requirement according to its label.

The recommendation connects the actual label to the shopper's specific requirement.

2. Which comparison is unsupported?

A. B will definitely last longer because it has a lining.

A lining alone does not establish comparative durability or wear performance.

3. Which statement preserves the purchase status?

B. Luis wants to inspect A but has not tried it on or bought it.

Inspection interest does not establish fit or a completed purchase.

4. What should resolve a further washing-temperature question?

D. The actual care-label instructions

The comparison supplies no temperature, so the actual garment information must be checked.

02 Conversation answers

Comparing fit, materials, and label information

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 19-20

1. care label. Turn 2. Care label provides the relevant evidence about cleaning, rather than relying on equal price or visual similarity.

2. lining. Turn 4. Lining is a construction feature, not by itself proof of the garment's care requirements or the reason for them.

3. machine-washable. Turn 6. Machine-washable reflects A's supplied label instruction, subject to the actual care details rather than invented settings.

4. only. Turn 8. Only limits the stated method for B; it should not be paraphrased as optional dry cleaning or machine-washing permission.

5. each. Turn 10. Each applies the sixty-dollar price separately to either jacket, not to the pair together.

6. fit. Turn 12. Fit concerns how the jacket sits on Luis, which has not been established by its label or price.

7. comfort claim. Turn 14. Comfort claim would assert an experience not established by the supplied construction and care facts or by Luis trying the jacket.

8. durability claim. Turn 16. Durability claim needs evidence about wear; neither equal price nor the presence of a lining supplies that evidence here.

9. size chart. Turn 18. Size chart can provide stated measurements for a fitting comparison, without guaranteeing fit before the shopper assesses the actual garment.

10. washing temperature. Turn 20. Washing temperature has not been supplied in this comparison; the actual label must answer it rather than an invented general setting.

F Transfer conversation

Page 21

1. C

Associate: "Jacket C meets the stated washing requirement."

C's actual label permits machine washing despite its lined construction.

2. each

Shopper: "Both jackets cost seventy dollars each."

Each states the price of either jacket separately, not the pair.

3. only

Associate: "Jacket D says dry-clean only."

Only preserves the restriction in D's supplied care instruction.

4. fit

Shopper: "The fit remains unverified."

Neither garment has been tried on, so fit is not established.

03 Briefing and language checks

Resolving shelf prices and offer conditions

A Briefing checks / page 22

1. What is the price of one bottle?

B. \$3

The offer leaves the single-bottle price at three dollars.

2. What qualifies for the \$5 offer?

D. Two qualifying bottles

The stated promotion requires a qualifying pair, not a single item.

3. Which choice does Nia make?

A. One bottle at \$3

Nia chooses the single bottle after the complete comparison is explained.

D Language checks / page 27

1. Which explanation is accurate?

B. \$2.50 is the pair's average per bottle; one alone is \$3.

The promotion has a quantity condition that division alone does not remove.

2. What is the saving on the pair against two regular-price bottles?

A. \$1

Two regular-price bottles cost six dollars, so the five-dollar pair saves one.

3. How much more does the pair cost than buying one bottle?

D. \$2

The five-dollar total exceeds the three-dollar single purchase by two dollars.

4. Which response respects the final choice?

D. One bottle at \$3; I will keep that quantity.

The shopper explicitly selects one, and its stated single price remains three dollars.

03 Conversation answers

Resolving shelf prices and offer conditions

03

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 28-29

- 1. quantity condition.** Turn 2. Quantity condition requires two qualifying bottles for the five-dollar offer, while one bottle remains at the stated single price.
- 2. average price.** Turn 4. Average price is five dollars divided by two within the qualifying pair; it is not a separate one-bottle selling price.
- 3. single-item price.** Turn 6. Single-item price is three dollars for one bottle alone, distinct from the lower average within the two-bottle offer.
- 4. qualifying items.** Turn 8. Qualifying items meet the stated promotion terms; an unrelated product cannot be assumed to count toward the required pair.
- 5. comparison basis.** Turn 10. Comparison basis is two bottles at the regular three-dollar price, giving six dollars against which the five-dollar offer saves one.
- 6. extra spending.** Turn 12. Extra spending compares the five-dollar pair with the three-dollar single purchase, showing a two-dollar increase in total outlay.
- 7. purchase preference.** Turn 14. Purchase preference is the shopper's choice based on actual need and total spending, which should not be overridden by the lower bundle average.
- 8. quantity read-back.** Turn 16. Quantity read-back confirms one bottle, preventing the explanation of the pair offer from being mistaken for permission to add another.
- 9. price query.** Turn 18. Price query concerns the difference between the quantity offer and the single-item price, not an invented loyalty requirement.
- 10. basket total.** Turn 20. Basket total is three dollars for the chosen single bottle under the fictional no-other-charges case, not the five-dollar pair price.

F Transfer conversation

Page 30

- 1. three**
Associate: "The offer requires three qualifying cans."
Three is the stated quantity required for the ten-dollar promotion.
- 2. four**
Shopper: "My one-can choice costs four dollars."
The single-can price remains four dollars despite the bundle offer.
- 3. two**
Associate: "The bundle saves two dollars against three regular-price cans."
Twelve dollars minus the ten-dollar bundle total gives a two-dollar saving.
- 4. one**
Shopper: "My selected quantity remains one."
The shopper chooses one rather than accepting the larger bundle.



04 Briefing and language checks

Checking the basket and payment status

04

A Briefing checks / page 31

1. What is the actual quantity?

B. One mug

The shopper has one mug even though two entries were recorded.

2. What is the corrected total?

B. \$8

One mug at eight dollars gives eight dollars with no additional charges.

3. What is the payment status?

A. Payment has not begun

The brief explicitly places the correction before any payment begins.

D Language checks / page 36

1. Which explanation is accurate?

B. One mug was recorded twice; the corrected total is \$8 before payment.

The correction removes an erroneous quantity while preserving the eight-dollar price.

2. Which term should not describe this correction?

C. Refund

Refund means returning paid money, but payment has not begun here.

3. What should the customer display show after correction?

D. One mug at \$8

The revised basket contains one eight-dollar mug before payment begins.

4. Which statement preserves the final stage?

C. The basket is corrected; payment is still next.

No payment attempt or completion occurs during this correction exchange.

04 Conversation answers

Checking the basket and payment status

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 37-38

1. duplicate scan. Turn 2. Duplicate scan means the same intended mug has been entered twice, not that the shopper selected two physical mugs.

2. physical quantity. Turn 4. Physical quantity is one mug, which the checkout record must match rather than leaving the two-entry mistake in place.

3. line item. Turn 6. Line item is the transaction entry showing the mug and its quantity; the duplicate produces the incorrect sixteen-dollar total.

4. payment status. Turn 8. Payment status is unstated, so the cashier must not describe this as a completed charge, decline, or refund.

5. quantity adjustment. Turn 10. Quantity adjustment changes the recorded number from two mugs to one while leaving the eight-dollar item price unchanged.

6. revised total. Turn 12. Revised total is eight dollars after the duplicate quantity is corrected, with no additional charges in the supplied case.

7. refund. Turn 14. Refund would return money already paid; no money has been taken because the payment has not begun.

8. amount due. Turn 16. Amount due is the eight dollars still to be paid, distinct from money already received or returned.

9. customer display. Turn 18. Customer display lets Leo verify the corrected quantity and total before the next payment step.

10. Transaction completion. Turn 20. Transaction completion has not yet occurred; the corrected basket is ready for the separate payment and completion steps.

F Transfer conversation

Page 39

1. one

Cashier: "The actual quantity is one bowl."

Only one physical bowl is being purchased in this scenario.

2. twelve

Shopper: "The corrected total is twelve dollars."

One bowl at twelve dollars gives the revised twelve-dollar total.

3. begun

Cashier: "Payment has not begun."

The correction occurs before any payment attempt starts.

4. refund

Shopper: "This is a correction, not a refund."

No money has been paid, so there is no paid amount to return.

04

05 Briefing and language checks

Discussing returns and exchanges at the counter

A Briefing checks / page 40

1. Which supplied policy conditions are met?

B. Unused shirt, attached tags, receipt, and purchase within thirty days

The brief confirms all four conditions of this fictional exchange policy.

2. What does Morgan want?

D. The same shirt in a larger size

The requested remedy is a larger-size exchange for the same shirt.

3. What remains unknown?

C. Larger-size availability

The replacement stock has not been checked despite the policy conditions being met.

D Language checks / page 45

1. Which explanation is accurate?

B. You meet the stated exchange conditions; I still need to check the larger size.

Eligibility is supported while replacement availability and processing remain unfinished.

2. Which outcome has the shopper requested?

B. Same-shirt exchange to a larger size

Morgan wants a particular replacement rather than any available remedy.

3. Which claim is unsupported?

B. Every store must use this exact thirty-day policy.

The stated policy is fictional and does not establish universal legal requirements.

4. What should be checked next?

B. Stock of the exact larger-size replacement

Replacement availability is the unresolved practical step after the supplied conditions are confirmed.

05 Conversation answers

Discussing returns and exchanges at the counter

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 46-47

1. exchange. Turn 2. Exchange is the requested replacement of the purchased shirt with a larger size, not an automatic refund or store credit.

2. replacement size. Turn 4. Replacement size is the specific larger variation Morgan requests, while the shirt style and color remain unchanged.

3. exchange window. Turn 6. Exchange window is thirty days in this fictional store, and the ten-day-old purchase falls within it.

4. eligibility. Turn 8. Eligibility means the stated unused-condition, tags, receipt, and time-window requirements are met, not that replacement stock is confirmed.

5. Replacement stock. Turn 10. Replacement stock is the inventory of the exact larger-size shirt, which has not yet been checked.

6. availability check. Turn 12. Availability check is the next verification of the exact requested variation, separate from confirming the exchange policy conditions.

7. requested remedy. Turn 14. Requested remedy is the larger-size exchange; an unavailable replacement would require another discussion rather than automatic substitution of a refund.

8. refund. Turn 16. Refund returns money already paid, whereas Morgan's exchange request seeks a replacement item.

9. proof of purchase. Turn 18. Proof of purchase supports the original transaction and date; presenting it does not itself complete an exchange.

10. pending exchange. Turn 20. Pending exchange means the conditions are met but the stock check and actual exchange steps remain unfinished.

F Transfer conversation

Page 48

1. within

Associate: "Seven days is within the stated window."

Seven days falls inside the twenty-one-day period supplied for this store.

2. small

Shopper: "The replacement size requested is small."

Small is the specific variation requested in this new case.

3. unchecked

Associate: "Replacement stock remains unchecked."

Meeting exchange conditions does not establish the replacement's availability.

4. exchange

Shopper: "The requested remedy is an exchange."

The shopper seeks a replacement shirt rather than an automatic refund.

05

06 Briefing and language checks

Explaining local stock and collection status

A Briefing checks / page 49

1. What does the message confirm?

B. Acknowledgment of order R61

The supplied message acknowledges the order but is not a collection-ready notice.

2. What remains unfinished?

B. One item is still being located

The order is not confirmed ready because one item is still being located.

3. What is promised for 3:00?

D. An update from Noor, even if unresolved

The commitment concerns communication at three, not a guaranteed stock outcome.

D Language checks / page 54

1. Which explanation is accurate?

B. The message acknowledges R61; one item is still being located.

The message and current location work do not establish complete readiness.

2. What does even if unresolved add?

C. The update still occurs without a final stock answer.

The phrase preserves the communication commitment despite an uncertain outcome.

3. Which statement wrongly turns an update into a promise?

A. Your complete order will definitely be ready at 3:00.

Readiness at three is not supported by the promised status update.

4. What needs separate agreement?

A. A proposed different size, color, or product

The shopper has not authorized any substitution for the ordered variation.

06 Conversation answers

Explaining local stock and collection status

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 55-56

- 1. order acknowledgment.** Turn 2. Order acknowledgment records receipt of R61, but it does not state that the complete order is ready for collection.
- 2. order line.** Turn 4. Order line identifies the individual item still being located, explaining why complete-order readiness has not been confirmed.
- 3. item location.** Turn 6. Item location remains unresolved; that does not by itself establish sold-out status or a particular cause.
- 4. contact owner.** Turn 8. Contact owner identifies Noor as responsible for the next communication, giving the shopper a specific person rather than an anonymous promise.
- 5. status update.** Turn 10. Status update communicates the latest verified position at three, even if the order cannot yet be confirmed ready.
- 6. update deadline.** Turn 12. Update deadline concerns the promised communication, not a guaranteed completion or collection time for the order.
- 7. substitution consent.** Turn 14. Substitution consent has not been given, so a different size, color, or product cannot be assumed acceptable.
- 8. variation match.** Turn 16. Variation match means checking the ordered size, color, and product rather than using a similar-looking alternative to close the order.
- 9. order reference.** Turn 18. Order reference is R61, connecting the unresolved item and Noor's three-o'clock update to this specific shopper's order.
- 10. Handover completion.** Turn 20. Handover completion has not occurred; the shopper has an acknowledged order and a promised update, not a completed collection.

F Transfer conversation

Page 57

1. P74

Associate: "The order reference is P74."

P74 connects the message and unresolved item to the correct order.

2. 4:30

Shopper: "The next update is at 4:30."

Four thirty is the promised communication time, not a readiness guarantee.

3. Jo

Associate: "The update owner is Jo."

Jo is explicitly responsible for the next status communication.

4. agreed

Shopper: "No substitution has been agreed."

An unresolved item does not authorize a different variation without agreement.

06

07 Briefing and language checks

Managing queues and offering practical assistance

A Briefing checks / page 58

1. What problem does Sam identify?

B. The current checkout is too narrow

Sam identifies the width of the current checkout, not a store-wide finding.

2. Which available route is offered?

B. Main aisle to the left toward open lane four

The brief supplies an open accessible checkout and a clear main-aisle route.

3. What help does Sam prefer?

C. Spoken directions, with belongings and aid left under personal control

The shopper chooses directions and does not authorize handling personal belongings or the aid.

D Language checks / page 63

1. Which opening respects the shopper's choice?

C. What help would you prefer with the route to lane four?

The question asks about practical preferences without assuming permission or demanding personal medical details.

2. Which action is authorized?

A. Giving spoken directions

Sam accepts directions and retains control of belongings and the mobility aid.

3. Which statement accurately describes the queue arrangement?

B. Lina will ask Noor to preserve the place; confirmation is pending.

The brief distinguishes the planned colleague request from an accepted arrangement.

4. Which route information is supplied?

C. Clear main aisle to the left, toward open lane four

The scenario provides a specific usable route, not a certification or invented shortcut.

07 Conversation answers

Managing queues and offering practical assistance

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 64-65

1. accessible checkout. Turn 2. Accessible checkout is the available lane four identified in this scenario, offering a practical alternative to the reported narrow lane.

2. spoken directions. Turn 4. Spoken directions are the form of assistance Sam chooses, without authorizing physical guidance or handling personal items.

3. main aisle. Turn 6. Main aisle is the clear route to the left supplied in the scenario, leading toward open lane four.

4. place in line. Turn 8. Place in line is Sam's existing service position, which Lina will ask the colleague to preserve during the move.

5. colleague coordination. Turn 10. Colleague coordination is still pending; Lina has proposed asking Noor but has not received confirmation.

6. assistance boundary. Turn 12. Assistance boundary limits help to the requested directions and coordination, excluding unrequested handling of the mobility aid or belongings.

7. permission. Turn 14. Permission must apply to a specific proposed action; a general offer of help does not authorize touching or carrying.

8. route confirmation. Turn 16. Route confirmation repeats the left-hand main aisle and lane-four destination so the shopper can verify the proposed path.

9. direct address. Turn 18. Direct address means speaking to Sam about Sam's preferences, rather than treating a companion as the automatic decision-maker.

10. pending request. Turn 20. Pending request is Noor's place-in-line coordination, which remains to be confirmed rather than reported as already complete.

F Transfer conversation

Page 66

1. six

Associate: "The open alternative is lane six."

Lane six is the available checkout stated in this new scenario.

2. right

Shopper: "The clear aisle is to the right."

Right identifies the supplied direction to the alternative lane.

3. directions

Associate: "The preferred help is spoken directions."

The shopper requests verbal route information rather than physical assistance.

4. pending

Shopper: "The place-in-line request is still pending."

The colleague has not yet responded, so the arrangement is unconfirmed.



08 Briefing and language checks

Handing over a till and an unfinished query

A Briefing checks / page 67

1. What is the recorded difference?

A. \$5 below expected

The recorded count of \$175 is five dollars below the expected \$180.

2. What verification is pending?

C. A second balance check

The brief states that the second check has not yet occurred.

3. What does Arun accept?

C. Both unfinished checks, not their completed outcomes

Arun takes the next actions without confirming a cause or completing either task.

D Language checks / page 72

1. Which handover is accurate?

C. Expected \$180, recorded \$175, second check pending, cause unknown.

The correct statement includes both figures, the verification stage, and the limit on causal claims.

2. What is known about P32?

A. Its price query is still open.

The price query remains unfinished, with no established connection to the balance difference.

3. Which statement wrongly treats ownership as completion?

C. Arun accepted both checks, so both issues are resolved.

Accepting follow-up responsibility does not perform the checks or supply their outcomes.

4. Which calculation matches the facts?

B. \$180 minus \$175 equals \$5 below expected.

The expected balance exceeds the recorded count by five dollars, with verification still pending.

08 Conversation answers

Handing over a till and an unfinished query

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 73-74

1. expected balance. Turn 2. Expected balance is the reference amount of 180 dollars, which must be distinguished from the recorded physical count.

2. recorded count. Turn 4. Recorded count is the initial 175-dollar figure, still awaiting a second check rather than a final verified outcome.

3. variance. Turn 6. Variance is the five-dollar difference between expected and recorded amounts; it does not establish the cause.

4. unverified discrepancy. Turn 8. Unverified discrepancy identifies the initial difference while acknowledging that the second check and causal review have not occurred.

5. open price query. Turn 10. Open price query is the separate unresolved P32 issue; no evidence links it to the drawer discrepancy.

6. action owner. Turn 12. Action owner is Arun, who accepts both next checks without claiming either is already completed.

7. second check. Turn 14. Second check is the pending verification of the drawer count, not an action completed merely by accepting responsibility.

8. proven loss. Turn 16. Proven loss would require a supported finding beyond the initial recorded difference; the current handover does not establish it.

9. handover status. Turn 18. Handover status preserves the pending recount, open P32 query, unknown cause, and Arun's accepted ownership without claiming resolution.

10. reconciliation. Turn 20. Reconciliation compares relevant amounts and records to explain a difference; it is subsequent work, not a conclusion already reached in this handover.

F Transfer conversation

Page 75

1. above

Cashier: "The recorded count is five dollars above expected."

Two hundred forty-five exceeds the expected two hundred forty by five dollars.

2. pending

Supervisor: "The second check is pending."

The check has not occurred merely because follow-up responsibility is accepted.

3. Q18

Cashier: "The open price query is Q18."

Q18 identifies the separate unresolved price matter in this handover.

4. unknown

Supervisor: "The cause remains unknown."

The initial arithmetic does not establish why the difference exists.

08

Find the move you need

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

01 Finding the item the shopper actually means

Narrow the advertisement: The ad shows two blue shirts; do you mean cotton or linen?

Distinguish the other item: L214 is the linen version.

Confirm before searching: I will use that exact reference and size for the stock inquiry.

Full phrase set: pages 7-8 | Dialogue: pages 10-11

02 Comparing fit, materials, and label information

Ask about the requirement: Is machine washing a requirement for you?

Compare construction: A is unlined; B has a lining.

Keep fit separate: We still need to check how it fits you.

Full phrase set: pages 16-17 | Dialogue: pages 19-20

03 Resolving shelf prices and offer conditions

Acknowledge the calculation: I see how you arrived at \$2.50 by dividing the pair price.

Explain the average: \$2.50 is the average per bottle when you buy the pair.

Explain the extra outlay: It is still \$2 more spending than buying one bottle.

Full phrase set: pages 25-26 | Dialogue: pages 28-29

04 Checking the basket and payment status

Acknowledge the duplicate: You are right; the mug has been recorded twice.

Explain the record: The current entry shows two at \$8, totaling \$16.

Keep status clear: Payment has not begun.

Full phrase set: pages 34-35 | Dialogue: pages 37-38

Keep the conversation productive

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

05 Discussing returns and exchanges at the counter

Clarify the requested outcome: Would you like the same shirt in a larger size?

Confirm the condition: The shirt is unused and the tags are attached.

Avoid a readiness promise: Eligibility does not mean the replacement is already available.

Full phrase set: pages 43-44 | Dialogue: pages 46-47

06 Explaining local stock and collection status

Identify the order: Let us check order R61.

Avoid a readiness claim: The complete order is not confirmed ready yet.

Keep the commitment precise: The update will happen even if the issue is still unresolved.

Full phrase set: pages 52-53 | Dialogue: pages 55-56

07 Managing queues and offering practical assistance

Acknowledge the barrier: I understand that this checkout is too narrow for you.

Describe the route: The clear main aisle to the left leads to lane four.

Avoid a personal inquiry: We can focus on the checkout route and the help you want.

Full phrase set: pages 61-62 | Dialogue: pages 64-65

08 Handing over a till and an unfinished query

State the expected figure: The expected drawer balance is \$180.

Mark the verification stage: The second check has not occurred yet.

Separate the other item: There is also an open price query for P32.

Full phrase set: pages 70-71 | Dialogue: pages 73-74

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

accessible checkout	offer the accessible checkout	59
action owner	name the action owner	69
advertised item	identify the advertised item	5
amount due	confirm the amount due	32
assistance boundary	respect the assistance boundary	60
attached tags	check attached tags	41
authorization	check authorization status	33
availability check	complete the availability check	42
availability claim	avoid an unsupported availability claim	6
average price	explain the average price	23
barcode	scan the barcode	5
basket correction	make a basket correction	32
basket total	confirm the basket total	24
branch	identify the branch	6
bundle total	state the bundle total	23
card terminal	identify the card terminal	33
care label	read the care label	14
cash difference	report the cash difference	68
cash drawer	check the cash drawer	68
cash drop	check the cash-drop record	69
cash movement	review cash movements	69
cash payment	process a cash payment	33
change	confirm the change	33
checkout	check the checkout total	32

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

checkout lane identify the checkout lane	59
clear route identify a clear route	59
colleague coordination coordinate with a colleague	60
collection colleague name the collection colleague	51
collection desk contact the collection desk	51
collection notice distinguish a collection notice	50
collection record update the collection record	51
colorfastness check colorfastness information	15
colorway identify the blue colorway	5
companion avoid addressing only the companion	60
comparison basis identify the comparison basis	23
complete order verify the complete order	50
contact owner identify the contact owner	51
contactless payment distinguish a contactless payment	33
cotton identify the cotton version	5
count sheet review the count sheet	69
coupon check a coupon	24
cuff compare cuff styles	15
customer display check the customer display	33
cut compare the cut	15
declined payment explain a declined payment	33
denomination check the denomination totals	69
direct address use direct address	60
display sample distinguish a display sample	6

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

dry-clean only explain the dry-clean-only instruction	14
duplicate scan correct a duplicate scan	32
durability claim avoid an unsupported durability claim	15
eligibility confirm exchange eligibility	41
established cause distinguish an established cause	69
exception request refer an exception request	42
exchange request an exchange	41
exchange processing complete exchange processing	42
exchange window check the exchange window	41
exclusion explain an exclusion	24
expected balance state the expected balance	68
extra spending explain the extra spending	24
fastening check the fastening	15
fiber blend read the fiber blend	14
fiber content check the fiber content	5
fit check the fit	15
fulfillment explain fulfillment status	50
garment compare the garments	14
hand wash distinguish a hand-wash instruction	14
handover completion confirm handover completion	51
handover status confirm the handover status	69
hem identify the hem	15
incoming supervisor brief the incoming supervisor	69
independent movement respect independent movement	60

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

item location confirm the item location	50
item reference confirm the item reference	5
knit fabric distinguish knit fabric	14
line item review the line item	32
lined describe the lined jacket	14
linen distinguish the linen version	5
lining identify the lining	14
local availability check local availability	6
loyalty price clarify the loyalty price	24
machine-washable check the machine-washable claim	14
main aisle describe the main aisle	59
manager review arrange manager review	42
measurement check the measurement	15
minimum purchase clarify the minimum purchase	24
mix-and-match check mix-and-match eligibility	24
mobility aid respect the mobility aid	59
multibuy offer explain the multibuy offer	23
narrow passage acknowledge a narrow passage	59
open lane identify the open lane	60
open price query hand over the open price query	69
opening float verify the opening float	68
order acknowledgment read the order acknowledgment	50
order line check the outstanding order line	50
order reference confirm the order reference	50

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

original packaging	identify original packaging	41
outer fabric	identify the outer fabric	14
overage	distinguish an overage	68
packing	distinguish packing from picking	50
partial order	describe a partial order	50
payment status	check the payment status	33
pending exchange	record the pending exchange	42
pending request	distinguish a pending request	60
permission	obtain permission before handling items	60
personal belongings	ask before handling belongings	59
physical check	request a physical check	6
physical guidance	ask before physical guidance	60
physical quantity	verify the physical quantity	32
picking	check picking status	50
pickup	explain pickup status	50
place in line	preserve a place in line	59
point-of-sale system	use the point-of-sale system	32
policy condition	explain a policy condition	42
preferred assistance	ask about preferred assistance	59
price difference	clarify any price difference	42
price per item	compare the price per item	23
price query	resolve a price query	24
product image	compare the product image	5
product variation	confirm the product variation	5

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

promotion period	check the promotion period	24
proof of purchase	check proof of purchase	41
proven loss	avoid claiming a proven loss	69
purchase date	confirm the purchase date	41
purchase preference	respect the purchase preference	24
qualifying item	identify a qualifying item	23
quantity adjustment	confirm the quantity adjustment	32
quantity condition	state the quantity condition	23
quantity read-back	give a quantity read-back	24
queue	manage the queue	59
queue transfer	arrange a queue transfer	60
range	identify the product range	5
readiness estimate	distinguish a readiness estimate	51
readiness promise	avoid an unsupported readiness promise	51
ready for collection	confirm ready-for-collection status	50
receipt	check the receipt	33
receipt	review the receipt	41
reconciliation	begin reconciliation	68
recorded count	report the recorded count	68
recorded quantity	correct the recorded quantity	32
recount	request a recount	68
redemption condition	explain redemption conditions	24
refund	distinguish a refund from a correction	33
refund	distinguish an exchange from a refund	41

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

regular price compare regular prices	23
replacement size check the replacement size	42
replacement stock check replacement stock	42
requested remedy confirm the requested remedy	42
reservation distinguish a reservation	6
return discuss a return	41
revised total read back the revised total	32
route confirmation give a route confirmation	60
same-style exchange request a same-style exchange	42
saving calculate the saving	23
scan scan the item	32
seam inspect the seam	15
second check complete the second check	68
shelf label check the shelf label	23
shop floor check the shop floor	6
shortfall describe a recorded shortfall	68
shrinkage avoid a shrinkage guarantee	15
single-item price confirm the single-item price	23
size confirm the requested size	5
size chart consult the size chart	15
specification repeat the specification	6
spoken directions offer spoken directions	60
status update give a status update	51
statutory rights distinguish statutory rights	42

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

stock inquiry make a stock inquiry	6
stock record consult the stock record	6
stock-keeping unit check the stock-keeping unit	5
stockroom check the stockroom	6
store credit clarify store-credit terms	41
substitution discuss a substitution	6
substitution consent obtain substitution consent	51
tender confirm the tender amount	33
till hand over the till	68
transaction completion confirm transaction completion	33
transaction log consult the transaction log	69
unit pricing distinguish unit pricing	23
unlined describe the unlined jacket	14
unresolved item track the unresolved item	51
unused condition confirm unused condition	41
unverified discrepancy record an unverified discrepancy	69
update deadline confirm the update deadline	51
variance quantify the variance	68
variation match check the variation match	51
void entry void the duplicate entry	32
walker identify a walker when relevant	59
wheelchair respect wheelchair users' choices	59
woven fabric identify woven fabric	14
zipper inspect the zipper	15

Original cases. Clear boundaries.

These are original fictional teaching conversations, not transcripts of real workers. Names, figures, organizations, and incidents are invented. Sources support terminology and communication aims, not the fictional results or an endorsement of this book.

[1] US Bureau of Labor Statistics. Retail Sales Workers.

[Open the original source](#)

Occupational context for product assistance, promotions, payment, receipts, and exchange-policy communication. The dialogues are original fictional teaching cases. Checked 1 October 2026.

[2] Federal Trade Commission. Clothes Captioning: Complying with the Care Labeling Rule.

[Open the original source](#)

Background for reading actual garment-care information rather than inventing care claims. The book does not prescribe laundering settings or summarize legal penalties. Checked 1 October 2026.

[3] Federal Trade Commission. Solving Problems With a Business: Returns, Refunds, and Other Resolutions.

[Open the original source](#)

Context for distinguishing requested remedies, purchase records, policies, and factual follow-up. The example exchange conditions are fictional, not universal rights. Checked 1 October 2026.

[4] US Department of Justice. ADA Update: A Primer for Small Business.

[Open the original source](#)

Background for accessible customer service and appropriate assistance. The supplied checkout route is fictional and is not an accessibility-compliance assessment. Checked 1 October 2026.

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